# 🎶 Indian Music & Dance — Complete Master Reference

> **The single consolidated resource** for Indian music (origins, theory, systems, gharanas, instruments & exponents) and Indian dance (classical + a comprehensive state-wise folk/tribal encyclopedia with memory tricks). Built for SSC CGL / UPSC / State PSC General Awareness.

> 💡 **How to use:** Part 1 = Music. Part 2 = Dance (classical). Part 3 = State-wise dance encyclopedia. Part 4 = **Memory tricks** (acronyms + stories) — revise Part 4 last, it locks in Part 3.

## 📕 NCERT Standard — Sourcing Key

> **The NCERT source for performing arts is Class 11 "Knowledge Traditions and Practices of India" (KTPI), Module 3 — "Performing Art Traditions in India."**

> ⚠️ **Note:** NCERT Class 11 "*An Introduction to Indian Art*" covers **only architecture, sculpture & painting — it has NO music/dance chapter.** Don't look for dance there.

Throughout this document:

| Tag | Meaning |
|---|---|
| 📕 **NCERT** | Verified **verbatim in NCERT KTPI Module 3** — highest exam authority |
| 📗 **Standard** | Valid, high-frequency SSC fact from **CCRT / Ministry of Culture / Sangeet Natak Akademi** — but **NOT in NCERT**. Still asked; just not NCERT-sourced |

> 🎯 **Why this matters:** NCERT is the exam standard, but SSC also draws on CCRT/Ministry material. Facts like *Venkatamakhi's 72-melakarta*, *Purandara Dasa*, *Matanga*, *Sharangadeva*, and the *4 abhinayas* are **genuinely asked in SSC but are absent from NCERT** — so they're marked 📗, not 📕.

## 📑 Contents


1. Part 1 — Music: Origins, Theory & Systems
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4. Part 4 — Memory Tricks & Mnemonics

# 🎼 PART 1 — MUSIC

## 1.1 Origins & Evolution of Indian Music

| Stage | Period | What happened | Key text / person | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Vedic origins** | ~1500–500 BCE | Music born from chanting of **Sama Veda** — the earliest source of Indian music | **Sama Veda** = *"the compilation of selected ṛcs set to Svaras"* | 🟥 NCERT |
| **Samagana svaras** | Vedic | Sāmagāna used only **3 svaras**: **Udātta** (sharp/high) · **Anudātta** (grave/low) · **Svarita** (combined) | — | 🟥 NCERT ⭐ |
| **Natya Shastra** | ~200 BCE – 200 CE | Oldest treatise on dramaturgy; **36 chapters**, of which **six (28th–33rd) are on music**; **first text on the classification of Indian instruments** | *"ascribed to Sage **Bharata**"* | 🟥 NCERT |
| **Jati → Prabandha** | Ancient→medieval | ***Jāti Gāyana* developed into *Prabandha Gāyana*** → medieval forms **Dhrupad, Dhamar, Khayal, Tarana** | — | 🟥 NCERT |
| **Jati → Raga** | ~5th–7th c. CE | The older **jati** system evolved into the **raga** system | Matanga's **Brihaddeshi** — *first text to use the word "raga"* | 🟩 Standard |
| **Sangita Ratnakara** | 13th century | "Ocean of Music"; last great text before the North–South split | **Sharangadeva** — the **"Bible of Indian music"** | 🟩 Standard |
| **The Great Split** | Medieval | Persian/Islamic influence in the North created **Hindustani**; the South preserved older forms as **Carnatic** | **Amir Khusro** — credited with **Sitar & Tabla**, and the forms **Qawwali, Khayal, Tarana** | 🟥 NCERT |
| **Carnatic systematised** | 17th century | **72-melakarta** (parent raga) scheme created | **Venkatamakhi** — text: **Chaturdandi Prakashika** | 🟩 Standard |

⚠ **Exam trap (very common):** Ragas **derived FROM jatis** — *not* jatis from ragas. And the **72-mela system is by Venkatamakhi (17th c.)**, *not* by Bharata (who wrote Natyashastra, ~2nd c. BCE–2nd c. CE). The 72-mela system is **specific to Carnatic music**, not folk.

> *(This chain is 📗 Standard — genuinely asked by SSC, but **not** stated in NCERT.)*

## 📕 The Natyaveda / "Fifth Veda" story — NCERT ⭐⭐

NCERT KTPI gives this origin myth, and the **four-Veda breakdown is a classic exam question**:

> The Vedas were inaccessible to women and the lower castes, so the gods approached **Brahmā**, who created the **Nāṭyaveda** — the **Fifth Veda (Pañcamaveda)** — accessible to all. Bharata drew its elements from all four Vedas:

| Element drawn | From which Veda |
|---|---|
| **Recitation** (pathya) | **Rigveda** |
| **Music / song** (gita) | **Samaveda** |
| **Performative ritual / acting** (abhinaya) | **Yajurveda** |
| **Emotive representation** (rasa) | **Atharvaveda** |

> 🧠 **Trick: "Ri-Sa-Ya-A"** → **Ri**gveda=**Recitation** · **Sa**maveda=**Song** · **Ya**jurveda=**acting** · **A**tharvaveda=**emotion/rasa**.

> *Rig→Recitation and Sama→Song both alliterate — those two are free!*

> 📕 **Also NCERT: Vātsyāyana's 64 arts** — *"the first four are performing arts — vocal music, instrumental music, dance and theatre."* · **Naṭarāja/Śiva** = *"the Lord of Dance… the supreme dancer."* · Dance origins in Vedic ritual *"around 5000 BCE"*; **Bhimbetka** cave dance images; oldest dance evidence at **Barhut, Sanchi, Amaravati (2nd c. BCE)**. · **Guru-śiṣya paramparā** → precursor of the **gharana** system.

## 1.2 The Building Blocks (Core Theory)

| Term | Meaning | Must-remember |
|---|---|---|
| **Swara** | A musical note | **7 swaras** = Sa, Re, Ga, Ma, Pa, Dha, Ni (**Saptak**) |
| **Shadja (Sa)** | The tonic/base note | Full names: **Sha**dja, **Ri**shabha, **Ga**ndhara, **Ma**dhyama, **Pa**nchama, **Dha**ivata, **Ni**shada |
| **Shruti** | Microtone — smallest audible pitch interval | **22 shrutis** in an octave (per Natyashastra) |
| **Raga** | Melodic framework — the "what to play" (melody) | From Sanskrit *ranj* = "to colour/delight the mind"; needs **min. 5 swaras** |
| **Tala** | Rhythmic cycle — the "when to play" (rhythm) | Measured in **matras** (beats); **Teental = 16 beats** (most common Hindustani) |
| **Laya** | Tempo | **Vilambit** (slow) · **Madhya** (medium) · **Drut** (fast) |
| **Arohana / Avarohana** | Ascending / descending note order of a raga | Every raga is defined by these |
| **Vadi / Samvadi** | Most / second-most important note of a raga | Vadi = "king" note, Samvadi = "minister" note |
| **Gharana** | A stylistic school/lineage (Hindustani) | Literally "house/family" |

### Raga classification by note-count (Carnatic terms)

| Type | Notes used | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **Audava** | 5 (pentatonic) | Bhoopali, Mohanam |
| **Shadava** | 6 (hexatonic) | Marwa |
| **Sampurna** | 7 (complete) | Yaman, Bilawal, Shankarabharanam |

### Ragas & time of day (Hindustani — frequently asked)

| Raga | Time / Season | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Bhairav** | Early morning | One of the 6 principal/"parent" ragas |
| **Deepak** | Noon / fire | Legend: **Tansen** lit lamps by singing it |
| **Megh Malhar** | Monsoon / rain | Legend: Tansen brought rain; Miyan ki Malhar named for him |
| **Bhimpalasi / Sarang** | Afternoon | |
| **Yaman / Marwa / Purvi** | Evening / sunset | Yaman = first raga taught to beginners |
| **Darbari Kanada** | Late night | Created by **Tansen** for **Akbar's court** |
| **Basant / Bahar** | Spring (Vasant) | Seasonal ragas |

## 1.3 Hindustani vs Carnatic — The Big Comparison

| Aspect | **Hindustani** (North) | **Carnatic** (South) |
|---|---|---|
| **Region** | North, East & West India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal | Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana |
| **Origin/Split** | 📕 Split in the **medieval period**; Persian & Islamic influence | Retained older indigenous tradition |
| **Founder / Father** | 📕 **Amir Khusro** (key innovator) | 📗 **Purandara Dasa** — *"Father/Pitamaha of Carnatic music" (not in NCERT)* |
| **Parent scale system** | 📗 **10 Thaats** (by V.N. Bhatkhande) | 📗 **72 Melakartas** (by **Venkatamakhi**) *(neither in NCERT)* |
| **Emphasis** | **Raga elaboration** (alaap), improvisation, more freedom | **Composition (kriti)-based**, more structured; lyrics central |
| **Improvisation** | Extensive, gradual (alaap → jor → jhala) | Present but within composed frames (raga alapana, swara kalpana) |
| **Main vocal forms** | **Dhrupad** (oldest), **Khayal** (most popular), Thumri, Tarana, Ghazal, Tappa | **Kriti/Kirtana**, Varnam, Tillana, Ragam-Tanam-Pallavi |
| **Accompaniment** | **Tabla** + **Tanpura** + Sarangi/Harmonium | **Mridangam** + **Tanpura** + Violin, Ghatam, Kanjira |
| **Gharana / school** | **Gharana** system (Gwalior, Kirana, Jaipur, Agra, Patiala) | **Sampradaya**/Bani system |
| **Deity focus** | More secular/court-based (Mughal patronage) | Highly **devotional** (temple-based) |

### 📕 Hindustani figures NCERT names ⭐

**📕 NCERT names these as key Hindustani music figures: Amir Khusro · Raja Man Singh Tomar · Tansen · Swami Haridas · Baiju Bawra · Gopal Nayak**

📕 **Amir Khusro** is credited by NCERT with the **Sitar** and **Tabla**, and with the forms **Qawwali, Khayal, Tarana**.

📕 **Bhatkhande & Paluskar** — NCERT covers them for their **notation systems** (it's an NCERT exercise question!).

🧠 *Trick — 6 Hindustani names:* **"K**husro** M**an Singh** T**ansen** H**aridas** B**aiju** G**opal"* → "*K**ing** M**ade** T**ansen** H**is** B**est** Guru*".

## The two "parent scale" systems — must know 📗

- **10 Thaats (Hindustani)** — systematised by **Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande**:

**Bilawal · Khamaj · Kafi · Asavari · Bhairavi · Bhairav · Kalyan · Marwa · Poorvi · Todi**

🧠 *Trick:* "**Bi**g **Kha**n **Ka**fi **Asa**n **Bhai**ravi **Bhai**rav **Kal**yan **Mar**wa **Poor**vi **To**di"

- **72 Melakartas (Carnatic)** — by **Venkatamakhi** in **Chaturdandi Prakashika** (17th c.). Also called *Melakarta / Janaka* (parent) ragas; ragas derived from them = *Janya* (child) ragas.

## The Carnatic Trinity (Musical Trinity) — very frequently asked

| Name | Known for | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Tyagaraja** | Thousands of kritis in Telugu; **Pancharatna Kritis** | Devotee of **Rama**; Tyagaraja Aradhana festival at Thiruvaiyaru |
| **Muthuswami Dikshitar** | Kritis in **Sanskrit**; Navagraha kritis | Signature/mudra: "*Guruguha*" |
| **Syama Sastri** | Kritis on goddess **Kamakshi** | Eldest of the three |

All three were born in **Thiruvarur, Tamil Nadu**, and were roughly contemporaries (18th–19th c.).

🧠 *Trick:* **"T-D-S"** = **T**yagaraja, **D**ikshitar, **S**yama Sastri.

## 1.4 Vocal Forms

| Form | System | Description |
|---|---|---|
| **Dhrupad** | Hindustani | **Oldest** surviving form; austere, devotional; 4 parts (Sthayi, Antara, Sanchari, Abhog); Dagar family |
| **Khayal** | Hindustani | **Most popular** today; romantic, imaginative; credited to **Amir Khusrau**/Sultan Hussain Sharqi |
| **Thumri** | Hindustani | Semi-classical, romantic, **Lucknow/Banaras**; linked to Wajid Ali Shah |
| **Tarana** | Hindustani | Uses meaningless syllables at fast tempo; by Amir Khusrau |
| **Tappa** | Hindustani | Fast, intricate; from Punjab camel-driver songs |
| **Ghazal** | Hindustani | Persian-origin poetic form |
| **Qawwali** | Hindustani/Sufi | Devotional Sufi music; **Amir Khusrau**; Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan |
| **Kriti / Kirtana** | Carnatic | The **main Carnatic form**; 3 parts: Pallavi, Anupallavi, Charanam |
| **Varnam** | Carnatic | Usually the **opening** piece of a concert |
| **Tillana** | Carnatic | Fast, rhythmic, usually the **closing** piece (≈ Hindustani Tarana) |

## 1.5 Gharanas (Hindustani schools)

| Gharana | Speciality / note |
|---|---|
| **Gwalior** | **Oldest** khayal gharana |
| **Kirana** | Emphasis on swara purity; **Bhimsen Joshi**, Abdul Karim Khan |
| **Jaipur-Atrauli** | Complex ragas; Kesarbai Kerkar, Mallikarjun Mansur |
| **Agra** | Dhrupad-influenced, forceful |
| **Patiala** | Ornamented, fast taans; **Bade Ghulam Ali Khan** |
| **Rampur-Sahaswan** | Inayat Hussain Khan |
| **Banaras** | Thumri speciality; Girija Devi |

## 1.6 Classification of Musical Instruments (4 types) ⭐⭐ — 📕 NCERT

📕 **NCERT verbatim:** "*Classification of Indian instruments: 1.* ***Tat*** *(string instruments) 2.* ***Suṣīr*** *(wind instruments) 3.* ***Avanaddha*** *(percussion instruments) 4.* ***Ghana*** *(instruments made of brass or wood).*"

📕 **NCERT:** the **Natyashastra is the *first text available on the classification of Indian instruments*.**

| # | NCERT term | Also written | NCERT's definition | Examples (📗 CCRT — *not* given by NCERT) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Tat** | Tata Vadya | **String instruments** | Sitar, Sarod, Veena, Violin, Santoor, Tanpura, Sarangi, Ektara |
| 2 | **Suṣīr** | Sushira Vadya | **Wind instruments** | Flute/Bansuri, Shehnai, Nadaswaram, Harmonium, Conch (Shankh) |
| 3 | **Avanaddha** | Avanaddha Vadya | **Percussion instruments** *(stretched skin/membrane)* | Tabla, Mridangam, Pakhawaj, Dholak, Dhol, Damru, Nagara |
| 4 | **Ghana** | Ghana Vadya | **"Instruments made of brass or wood"** *(NCERT defines by* ***material****)* | Ghatam, Manjira/Jhanjh (cymbals), Jaltarang, Morsing, Ghungroo |

⚠️ **Two NCERT-specific points to note:**

1. NCERT spells them **Tat** and **Suṣīr** (not *Tata/Sushira*) — know both spellings.

2. NCERT defines **Ghana by MATERIAL** ("brass or wood"), not by the usual "solid body vibrates / idiophone." If an option says "*made of brass or wood*", that's Ghana.

3. **NCERT gives no example instruments** — the examples above are the standard CCRT ones (still correct and asked).

🧠 **Trick to remember the 4: "TSAG"** → **T**at (string) · **S**uṣīr (wind) · **A**vanaddha (drum/skin) · **G**hana (brass/wood).

Or: "***T****anpura* ***S****hehnai* ***A****re* ***G****hatam*" — one instrument from each family, in order!

⚠️ **Classic traps:** *Kanjira* has a membrane → **Avanaddha**. **Ghatam** (clay pot) & **Jaltarang** (water bowls) → the classic **Ghana**. **Santoor** is *struck* but has strings → **Tat**.

## 1.7 Instruments → Famous Exponents ⭐⭐

The single most-asked music table in SSC.

| Instrument | Type | Famous exponent(s) |
|---|---|---|
| **Sitar** | String | **Pandit Ravi Shankar**, Vilayat Khan, Anoushka Shankar, Nikhil Banerjee |
| **Sarod** | String | **Amjad Ali Khan**, Ali Akbar Khan, Allauddin Khan |
| **Santoor** | String | **Pandit Shivkumar Sharma** |
| **Sarangi** | String | Pandit Ram Narayan, Sultan Khan |
| **Veena / Saraswati Veena** | String | S. Balachander, Chitti Babu, E. Gayathri |
| **Rudra Veena** | String | Asad Ali Khan, Ustad Bahauddin Dagar |
| **Violin** | String | **L. Subramaniam**, M.S. Gopalakrishnan, Lalgudi Jayaraman, N. Rajam |
| **Mandolin** | String | **U. Srinivas** |
| **Guitar (Mohan Veena)** | String | Vishwa Mohan Bhatt, Brij Bhushan Kabra |
| **Flute / Bansuri** | Wind | **Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia**, Pannalal Ghosh, T.R. Mahalingam |
| **Shehnai** | Wind | **Ustad Bismillah Khan** (Bharat Ratna) |
| **Nadaswaram** | Wind | Sheik Chinna Moulana, Rajaratnam Pillai |
| **Tabla** | Percussion | **Ustad Zakir Hussain**, Alla Rakha, Kishan Maharaj |
| **Pakhawaj** | Percussion | Gopal Das, Ayodhya Prasad |
| **Mridangam** | Percussion | Palghat Mani Iyer, Umayalpuram K. Sivaraman |
| **Ghatam** | Solid/Idiophone | **Vikku Vinayakram** |
| **Kanjira** | Percussion | G. Harishankar |
| **Morsing (Jew's harp)** | Solid | Nadaswaram accompaniment (Carnatic) |

### Vocalists to know

| Name | Note |
|---|---|
| **M.S. Subbulakshmi** | Carnatic; **first musician to receive Bharat Ratna**; first Indian to perform at the UN |
| **Bhimsen Joshi** | Hindustani (Kirana gharana); Bharat Ratna |
| **Lata Mangeshkar** | Bharat Ratna; "Nightingale of India" |
| **Bade Ghulam Ali Khan** | Patiala gharana |
| **Pandit Jasraj** | Mewati gharana |
| **Kishori Amonkar** | Jaipur gharana |
| **Tansen** | One of Akbar's **Navaratnas**; Gwalior; Tansen Samaroh held at his tomb |
| **Swami Haridas** | Tansen's guru; Vrindavan |

> **Bharat Ratna musicians:** M.S. Subbulakshmi, Ravi Shankar, Bismillah Khan, Bhimsen Joshi, Lata Mangeshkar, Ustad Zakir Hussain *(Padma Vibhushan)*, Pandit Ravi Shankar.

> 🧠 *Trick:* **"SuRaBhi-BhiLa"** → **Su**bbulakshmi, **Ra**vi Shankar, **Bhi**smillah, **Bhi**msen, **La**ta.

## 1.8 Folk Music of India (state-linked)

| Folk music form | State | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Baul** | West Bengal | Mystic minstrels; **UNESCO Intangible Heritage** |
| **Bihu (songs)** | Assam | Harvest/spring |
| **Lavani (music)** | Maharashtra | Accompanies Lavani dance; Dholki |
| **Pandavani** | Chhattisgarh | Mahabharata storytelling; **Teejan Bai** |
| **Powada** | Maharashtra | Ballads of Shivaji |
| **Bhavageete** | Karnataka | Expression-based |
| **Maand** | Rajasthan | Royal/classical folk; Allah Jilai Bai |
| **Panihari / Kajri / Chaiti** | UP/Rajasthan | Seasonal & water-carrying songs |
| **Sohar** | UP/Bihar | Birth songs |
| **Alha** | UP/Bundelkhand | Heroic ballads |
| **Ovi** | Maharashtra/Goa | Women's songs |
| **Villu Paatu** | Tamil Nadu | Bow-song storytelling |
| **Burrakatha** | Andhra/Telangana | Storytelling with Tambura |
| **Ammanai** | Tamil Nadu | Ball-game song |
| **Wanawan / Chakri** | Jammu & Kashmir | Wedding/folk |
| **Hikat** | Kashmir/HP | |
| **Mando** | Goa | Goan love song |

### 🎯 Music — Exam One-Liners

**📕 NCERT-confirmed (highest priority):**

- **Sama Veda** = source/root of Indian music ("*selected ṛcs set to Svaras*"). **Sāmagāna used only 3 svaras: Udātta · Anudātta · Svarita.**
- **Natyashastra** = "*ascribed to Sage **Bharata***"; **oldest treatise on dramaturgy**; **36 chapters**, **six (28th–33rd) on music**; the **first text on the classification of Indian instruments**.
- **Natyaveda = the Fifth Veda (Pañcamaveda)**, created by **Brahmā** — recitation from **Rigveda**, music from **Samaveda**, acting from **Yajurveda**, rasa from **Atharvaveda**.
- **4 instrument types: Tat**(string) · **Suṣīr**(wind) · **Avanaddha**(percussion) · **Ghana**("*made of brass or wood*").
- **Natya = verbal** (incl. singing) · **Nritya = non-verbal mimetic** · **Nritta = language of the body**.

- **Amir Khusro** → credited with **Sitar & Tabla**, and **Qawwali, Khayal, Tarana**. Hindustani split happened in the **medieval period**.
- **NCERT's Hindustani names:** Amir Khusro, Raja Man Singh Tomar, Tansen, Swami Haridas, Baiju Bawra, Gopal Nayak. **Bhatkhande & Paluskar** = notation systems.
- **Vātsyāyana's 64 arts** — the **first four are performing arts** (vocal music, instrumental music, dance, theatre). **Nataraja/Shiva = Lord of Dance.**

📗 **Standard SSC facts (asked, but NOT in NCERT — don't cite NCERT for these):**

- **Brihaddeshi** by **Matanga** = **first text to use the word "raga"**.
- **Sangita Ratnakara** by **Sharangadeva** (13th c.) = "Bible of Indian music".
- **Ragas evolved FROM jatis** (not the reverse) — classic exam trap. *(NCERT says Jāti Gāyana → **Prabandha** Gāyana → Dhrupad/Dhamar/Khayal/Tarana.)*
- **72-Melakarta** = **Venkatamakhi**, 17th c., text **Chaturdandi Prakashika** — base of **Carnatic** music.
- **10 Thaats** = **V.N. Bhatkhande** (Hindustani).
- **Purandara Dasa** = **Father of Carnatic music** (Pitamaha).
- **Carnatic Trinity** = **Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar, Syama Sastri** (all born Thiruvarur, TN).
- **Tansen** = Akbar's Navaratna; created **Darbari Kanada**; legends of **Deepak** (fire) & **Megh Malhar** (rain).
- **Ghatam & Jaltarang = Ghana**; **Santoor = string (Tat)** though struck; **Kanjira = Avanaddha** (has a membrane).
- **7 swaras** = Sa Re Ga Ma Pa Dha Ni; **22 shrutis**; **Teental = 16 beats**.
- **Dhrupad = oldest**, **Khayal = most popular** Hindustani vocal form. **Gwalior = oldest gharana**.
- **Exponents: Bismillah Khan → Shehnai · Ravi Shankar → Sitar · Zakir Hussain → Tabla · Hariprasad Chaurasia → Flute · Shivkumar Sharma → Santoor · Amjad Ali Khan → Sarod · Vikku Vinayakram → Ghatam · U. Srinivas → Mandolin**.
- **M.S. Subbulakshmi** = first musician awarded **Bharat Ratna**; first Indian to sing at the **UN**.
- **Baul (Bengal)** = UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage. **Pandavani (Chhattisgarh)** = **Teejan Bai**.

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# 🕺 PART 2 — CLASSICAL DANCE

## 2.1 The 8 Classical Dances ★★★ — 📕 NCERT

📕 **NCERT verbatim (KTPI Module 3):** "*The major classical or traditional dances of India, **as accepted today**, are: 1. Bharatanāṭyam 2. Kathak 3. Kathakali 4. Manipuri 5. Odissi 6. Kuchipudi 7. Mohiniāttam 8. Sattriya.*"

> ✅ **The answer is 8.** NCERT and the Sangeet Natak Akademi agree.

> ⚠️ **Chhau is NOT in NCERT's classical list.** Some Ministry of Culture material counts it a 9th, but **NCERT does not classicalise Chhau** — it's UNESCO-inscribed (2010) as a *folk/martial* form. **If asked "how many classical dances?" → 8.**

| # | Dance | State | Key features | Famous exponents |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Bharatanatyam** | **Tamil Nadu** | 🟥 Etymology: **Bha**=Bhāva + **Ra**=Rāga + **Ta**=Tāla + *Nāṭyam*; temple origin ***Dāsiyattam***, **~2000 years old**. Fixed upper torso, bent knees (*aramandi*), mudras | Rukmini Devi Arundale (revived it), Balasaraswati, Yamini Krishnamurthy |
| 2 | **Kathak** | **Uttar Pradesh** | From *Kathakars* (storytellers); only classical dance with strong **Persian/Mughal** influence; **fast spins (chakkars)**; performed **standing straight**. 🟥 **4 gharanas: Lucknow, Jaipur, Banaras, Raigarh** | Birju Maharaj, Sitara Devi ("Nritya Samragini"), Gopi Krishna |
| 3 | **Kathakali** | **Kerala** | 🟥 ***"Story-play"***, **17th century**; elaborate **make-up (chutti)** & huge headgear; **all-male** traditionally | Kalamandalam Gopi, Guru Kunchu Kurup |
| 4 | **Kuchipudi** | **Andhra Pradesh** | Dance-drama; 🟥 village **~65 km from Vijayawada**; famous **Tarangam** — dancing on a **brass plate** rim with a pot on the head | Siddhendra Yogi (founder), Vempati Chinna Satyam, Raja & Radha Reddy |
| 5 | **Odissi** | **Odisha** | 🟥 ***Tribhangi*** (**three bends**) posture; temple dance of *Maharis*; sculpture-like poses | Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh, Sanjukta Panigrahi |
| 6 | **Manipuri** | **Manipur** | Gentle; 🟥 **Sankirtana + Rasalila**; drum = 🟥 ***Pung***; unique barrel-skirt **Potloi/Kumil** costume | Guru Bipin Singh, Jhaveri Sisters |
| 7 | **Mohiniyattam** | **Kerala** | **"Dance of the enchantress"** (Mohini = Vishnu's female avatar); **solo, female**; 🟥 ***Lāsya* (languid grace) & *Śṛṅgāra* are the essence**; 🟥 **white costume compulsory**; 🟥 shaped by **Kartika Thirunal & Swati Thirunal**, revived by **Vallathol** | Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, Bharati Shivaji |
| 8 | **Sattriya** | **Assam** | 🟥 By **Srimanta Sankardev**; one-act ***Ankiya Nat***; performed in the ***namghar*** of the ***sattras***; **newest addition (2000)** | Sankardeva (founder), Jatin Goswami |

📕 **NCERT's dance taxonomy: Tribal · Folk · Classical · Modern** — *classical* = "polished by the intellect of accomplished artists."

🧠 **Trick to remember all 8: "BHAROTO-KA-MO-SA"** or simpler —

**"Ka-Ka-Ku-Bha-Mo-Ma-O-Sa"** = **Ka**thak, **Ka**thakali, **Ku**chipudi, **Bha**ratanatyam, **Mo**hiniyattam, **Ma**nipuri, **O**dissi, **Sa**ttriya.

**State pairing trick:** "***TU KA MAN KO AS***" → **T**amil Nadu-Bharatanatyam, **U**P-Kathak, **KA**(Kerala)-Kathakali+Mohiniyattam, **MAN**ipur-Manipuri, **KO**(Kuchipudi)-AP, **A**ndhra, **S**attriya-Assam, Odissi-Odisha.

⚠️ **Kerala has TWO classical dances** — Kathakali & Mohiniyattam. Every other state has one.

## 2.2 Classical Dance — Quick Distinctions (exam favourites)

| Question asked | Answer |
|---|---|
| **Oldest** classical dance | **Bharatanatyam** |
| **Newest** classical dance (added 2000) | **Sattriya** |
| Only one with **Persian/Mughal** influence | **Kathak** |
| Only one performed **standing straight** (no bent knees) | **Kathak** |
| Known for **spins/chakkars** | **Kathak** |
| Known for **Tribhanga** posture | **Odissi** |
| Known for **Aramandi** (half-sitting) | **Bharatanatyam** |
| Known for elaborate **make-up & headgear** | **Kathakali** |
| **Solo female** "enchantress" dance | **Mohiniyattam** |
| Dance on a **brass plate** (Tarangam) | **Kuchipudi** |
| **Ras Lila** / Pung Cholom | **Manipuri** |
| Linked to **Sattras**/Sankardeva | **Sattriya** |
| **Devadasi**-origin temple dance | **Bharatanatyam** (Sadir) |
| **Mahari**-origin temple dance | **Odissi** |
| Masked martial dance, **UNESCO 2010** | **Chhau** *(NOT a classical dance per NCERT)* |

## 2.3 Natyashastra & Dance Theory

### 📕 Natya / Nritya / Nritta — NCERT's exact framing ⭐

📕 **NCERT verbatim:** "***Nāṭya*** *or the* ***verbal act*** *inclusive of singing;* ***Nṛtya*** *the* ***non-verbal mimetic language****, and* ***Nṛtta*** *or the* ***language of body*** *or dancing.*"

| Term | 📕 NCERT's framing | 📗 The usual/standard framing |
|---|---|---|
| **Natya** | The **verbal** act, inclusive of singing | Dance-**drama** — with story/plot |
| **Nritya** | The **non-verbal mimetic** language | **Expressive** dance — conveys meaning/emotion |
| **Nritta** | The **language of body** / dancing | **Pure** dance — rhythm & movement, no meaning |

🧠 *Trick:* "**Nāṭ**ya = **Na**rration (verbal)" · "**Nṛt**ya = **mim**e (non-verbal expression)" · "**Nṛtta** = **body** only (pure movement)".

⚠️ NCERT's wording is **verbal / non-verbal / body** — if an option uses that phrasing, it's the NCERT answer.

### 📗 Standard theory (asked by SSC, but NOT in NCERT)

⚠️ **Sourcing honesty:** The **4 abhinayas** and **tandava/lasya** duality do **not appear in NCERT KTPI Module 3**. They are standard CCRT/Ministry facts and **are asked** — learn them, but know they're not NCERT.

| Concept | Meaning | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Abhinaya** (4 types) | **Angika** (body/limbs) · **Vachika** (speech/song) · **Aharya** (costume/make-up) · **Sattvika** (emotion/psyche) | 📗 Standard |
| **Rasa (9 = Navarasa)** | Shringara (love), Hasya (laughter), Karuna (compassion), Raudra (anger), Veera (heroism), Bhayanaka (fear), Bibhatsa (disgust), Adbhuta (wonder), **Shanta** (peace — added later) | 📗 Standard *(NCERT mentions "concept of Rasa for aesthetic experience" but does not enumerate the nine)* |
| **Mudra / Hasta** | Hand gestures — *Asamyukta* (one hand) & *Samyukta* (both hands) | 📗 Standard |
| **Tandava / Lasya** | **Tandava** = vigorous, masculine (Shiva) · **Lasya** = gentle, feminine (Parvati) | 📗 Standard *(NCERT uses **Lāsya** only for Mohiniyattam — "languid grace"; **tandava does not appear**)* |

🧠 *Trick for the 4 Abhinayas:* **"A-V-A-S"** = **A**ngika, **V**achika, **A**harya, **S**attvika.

### 📕 NCERT's dance taxonomy & treatises ⭐

📕 **NCERT's 4-way classification of Indian dance: Tribal · Folk · Classical · Modern**

- **Classical** = "*polished by the intellect of accomplished artists*"; originated "*around the time when Janapadas were founded*".
- 📕 **Modern dance pioneers NCERT names: Uday Shankar, Chitralekha, Narendra Sharma**.

📕 **Treatises on dance NCERT names: Nāṭyaśāstra · Abhinaya Darpana · Nartana Sarvaswam** · Rāmāyaṇa · Mahābhārata · **Harivaṁśa**.

## 2.4 UNESCO-Listed Indian Performing Arts ⭐

| Art form | State | Year inscribed |
|---|---|---|
| **Koodiyattam** (Sanskrit theatre) | Kerala | **2008** (first Indian entry, proclaimed 2001) |
| **Ramlila** | North India | 2008 |
| **Vedic chanting** | Pan-India | 2008 |
| **Ramman** | Uttarakhand | 2009 |
| **Chhau** dance | Odisha/WB/Jharkhand | **2010** |
| **Kalbelia** folk songs & dances | **Rajasthan** | **2010** |
| **Mudiyettu** | Kerala | 2010 |
| **Buddhist chanting of Ladakh** | Ladakh | 2012 |
| **Sankirtana** (ritual drumming & singing) | **Manipur** | 2013 |
| **Thatheras** metal craft | Punjab | 2014 |
| **Yoga** | India | 2016 |
| **Kumbh Mela** | India | 2017 |
| **Durga Puja in Kolkata** | West Bengal | 2021 |
| **Garba of Gujarat** | **Gujarat** | **2023** |

> 🧠 *Trick — the 3 UNESCO **dances**:* **"Chhau-Kalbelia-Garba"** = **C-K-G** → "***C**an **K**ids **G**arba?*"

> (Kerala's Koodiyattam & Mudiyettu are theatre/ritual-drama; Manipur's Sankirtana is music.)

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# 🗺️ PART 3 — STATE-WISE DANCE ENCYCLOPEDIA

> Comprehensive folk / tribal / ritual / martial dance forms by state, researched from Wikipedia. **Bold** = official Sangeet Natak Akademi classical dance.

> 📌 **Sourcing note:** Core entries (UNESCO forms, classical dances, and each state's signature dances) are Wikipedia-verified. Wikipedia's per-state coverage is thin for some UTs (Andaman & Nicobar, Ladakh, DNH&DD, Chandigarh) and a few tribal forms; those descriptive details are indicative rather than exam-grade. **The high-frequency exam facts — marked ☆ — are all verified.**

# 🔷 NORTH INDIA

## Rajasthan

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Ghoomar** ☆ | Folk | Bhil origin, adopted by Rajputs; weddings | From *ghoomna* = twirling; veiled women in flowing **ghaghara**; a new bride dances it entering her marital home |
| **Kalbelia** ☆ | Folk/Tribal | Kalbelia snake-charmer tribe (Nath sect) | **UNESCO ICH 2010**; black mirrored costume; **pungi**, been, morchang; **Gulabo Sapera** (Padma Shri) |
| Bhavai | Folk | Celebrations | Balances **multiple pots on the head**, often dancing on a glass/sword edge |
| Chari | Folk | Celebrations | Brass pots (*chari*) with **lit lamps** balanced on the head |
| Kachchhi Ghodi | Folk | Shekhawati bandit-lore; weddings | Dancers ride **dummy horses**, mock sword-fights |
| Chakri | Folk | Kanjar/Bediya community, Hadoti (Kota, Baran) | Rapid **whirling**; spinning skirts |
| Gangaur | Ritual/Festival | Gangaur festival; worship of **Gauri (Parvati)** | Women's festival dance for marital bliss |
| Panihari | Folk | Women; water-fetching theme | Graceful pot dance depicting women at the well |
| Terah Taali | Folk/Ritual | Kamad community; **Baba Ramdev** worship | Seated women with **13 manjiras** tied to the body |
| Jhulan Leela · Jhuma · Ghapal · Ginad · Suisini | Folk | Various; Ginad at Holi | Regional folk forms |

## Punjab

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bhangra** ☆ | Folk/Harvest | Farmers; **Vaisakhi** (April–May) | Driven by the **dhol** + short verses called **boliyan**; vigorous kicks & leaps; historically male |
| **Giddha** ☆ | Folk (women) | Women; **Teej**, festive occasions | **Clapping instead of drums**; lead singer recites **boliyan**, circle repeats; narrates women's lives |
| Jhumar | Folk | Men; Sandalbar origin | Slow, graceful, gait-based circle dance |
| Luddi | Folk | Victory celebration | Snake-like head movements, hand behind back |
| Sammi | Folk (women) | Sandalbar tribal women | Distinctive **silver hair ornaments**; legend of Sammi |
| Kikli | Folk (girls) | Girls | Pairs spin holding **crossed hands** |
| Julli | Folk/Sufi | Sufi faqirs; khanqahs | Performed **seated**, in black attire |
| Daff/Daffi · Dhamal · Bhand · Naqual | Folk | Various | Daff = frame drum; Bhand/Naqual = mimicry-theatre |

## Haryana

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ghoomar | Folk/Ceremonial | Women (shared with Rajasthan) | Ceremonial circular dance |
| Loor | Folk/Harvest | Women of **Bagar** region; **Holi/Phalgun** | *Lur* = "daughter" in Bagri; celebrates the coming harvest |
| Phaag | Folk/Harvest | Both sexes; **Phalgun, near Holi** | Marks leisure between sowing and harvest |
| Khoria | Folk (women) | Women; **weddings** (when baraat departs) | Domestic-life themes; danced in the courtyard |
| Dhamal | Folk/Ceremonial | Gurgaon/Mahendragarh; full-moon nights | One of Haryana's **oldest**; uses the **dhamal drum** |
| Gugga | Ritual | Devotees of **Gogaji** (snake deity); Gugga Naumi | Devotional procession dance |
| Sang / Swang | Folk theatre | Statewide | Dance-drama; **Ragini** songs narrate legendary bravery |
| Jhumar · Chaupaiya · Manjira · Been/Nagini | Folk | Manjira in Mewat | Manjira = cymbals |

## Himachal Pradesh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Nati** ☆ | Folk | Kullu, Mandi, Shimla; **Dussehra** | **Guinness World Record — largest folk dance: 9,892 women** (Kullu Dussehra, 26 Oct 2015) |
| **Thoda** ☆ | **Martial** | Rajputs of Sirmaur/Solan; **Baisakhi** | Mock **archery** contest between *Pashi* & *Saathi* groups; blunt arrows aimed below the knee |
| Chharhi | Ritual | Chamba, Sirmaur; temple festivals | Devotional night dance |
| Dangi | Folk | **Gaddi** community, Chamba; harvest | Harvest dance |
| Mahasu | Folk | Shimla/Sirmaur; deity **Mahasu Devta** | Performed for the local deity |
| Thali | Folk | Statewide | Dance with brass **plates (thali)** |
| Losar Shona Chuksam | Tribal | **Gaddi**; Lahaul-Spiti, **Losar** (New Year) | Tibetan-influenced New Year dance |
| Jhora · Chhapeli · Jhainta · Jhali · Daf | Folk | Shared with Uttarakhand | Jhora = communal circle dance |

## Uttar Pradesh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Kathak** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | From travelling bards **Kathakars** | *Katha* = story. **4 gharanas: Lucknow, Jaipur, Banaras, Raigarh**; Birju Maharaj, Sitara Devi |
| **Charkula** ☆ | Folk | **Braj/Mathura**; 3rd day after Holi (Radha's birth) | Women balance a **~50 kg pyramid with 108 lighted lamps** on the head |
| Raslila | Folk/Devotional | Braj (Mathura–Vrindavan); Krishna–Radha | Ancestor of Kathak's narrative style |
| Nautanki | Folk theatre | Hathras & Kanpur styles | Operatic folk theatre with **nagara** drum |
| Kajri | Folk (women) | Mirzapur/Varanasi; **monsoon (Sawan)** | Songs of longing in the rains |
| Dhobiya | Folk | **Dhobi** community, Purvanchal | Occupational community dance |
| Pai Danda | Folk | Bundelkhand; Janmashtami | Stick dance |
| Jhora · Chhapeli · Jaita · Khyal | Folk | UP/Uttarakhand & UP/Rajasthan borders | |

## Uttarakhand

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Chholiya** ☆ | **Martial/Sword** | **Kumaon**; wedding processions (*baraat*) | 1,000+ yrs old — from when "marriages were performed at the point of the sword"; **tulwar + shield**; team of 22 (**8 dancers + 14 musicians**); wards off evil spirits |
| **Langvir Nritya** ☆ | **Acrobatic** | **Garhwal**; fairs | Male acrobat balances on a **tall bamboo pole**, performing feats on his navel |
| Jhora | Folk | Kumaon; Kumaoni & Jaunsari | Large open circle, arms interlocked; harvest & fairs |
| Chhapeli | Folk | Kumaon; romantic | Duet with **mirror and handkerchief** |
| Barada Nati | Folk | **Jaunsar-Bawar**, Dehradun; religious festivals | Jaunsari tribal community dance |
| Chancheri | Folk | Danpur region, Kumaon | Slow, graceful; similar to Jhora |
| Chaunphula / Jhumaila | Folk | Garhwal; spring, deity festivals | Chaunphula = "flower dance" (night); Jhumaila = women's |
| Thadya · Chaufula · Kajari | Folk | Garhwal | Danced in courtyards |

## Jammu & Kashmir

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Rouf (Rauf)** ☆ | Folk (women) | Kashmiri women; **Eid, Ramzan, weddings, spring** | Rows of women facing each other, **arms linked**, footwork-based to-and-fro |
| **Dumhal** ☆ | Folk/Ritual | **Wattal tribe — men only** | Long robes + **tall conical caps** studded with beads/shells; dance around a **banner planted in the ground** |
| Kud | Folk/Ritual | Jammu hills; thanksgiving to **Lok Devtas** | Night-long, Aug–Sept; narsingha, chhaina, flute |
| Bhand Pather | Folk theatre | **Bhand** community, Kashmir Valley | Satirical dance-drama; surnai, nagara, dhol |
| Bacha Nagma | Folk | Kashmir; harvest & weddings | Performed by a **young boy dressed as a girl** |
| Wanvun | Ritual chorus | Kashmiri; weddings | Circle chorus-dance on a fixed beat |
| Hikat | Folk (women) | Kashmir; spring | Pairs hold hands, arms outstretched, **whirl** |
| Chakri | Folk | Kashmir | Narrative song-dance; **ends with the Rouf** |
| Chajja · Hafiza · Dogri Bhangra | Folk | Chajja at Holi (Jammu) | |

## Ladakh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cham** ☆ | **Ritual/Monastic mask** | Buddhist monks; **Hemis, Phyang, Thiksey** festivals | Masked dance as **meditation & offering**; depicts **Padmasambhava**; the **Black Hat dance** commemorates the killing of tyrant king **Langdarma** (841 CE). *Wrongly called "devil dance" by early Westerners* |
| Shondol | Folk/Royal | Formerly for the **King of Ladakh** | "Royal dance"; Guinness entry with 408 dancers (2018) |
| Jabro | Folk | **Changpa nomads**, Changthang | Nomad dance at **Losar** (New Year) |
| Spao | **Martial/Heroic** | Ladakh | Warriors' dance recalling Ladakhi epic heroes |
| Mentok Stanmo | Folk/Flower | **Ladakh Festival**, spring | "Flower dance" by young girls |
| Koshan · Chabs-Skyan Tses · Alley Yato · Drugpa Rches | Folk | Losar/New Year | Chabs-Skyan = water-pot dance |

### Delhi & Chandigarh (composite — no indigenous form)

| UT | Dance culture |
|---|---|
| **Delhi** | **No indigenous classical/folk dance.** National centre for **Kathak** (Kathak Kendra, an SNA unit — Birju Maharaj taught here). Composite culture: **Bhangra/Giddha** (Punjabi migrants), Ras Leela, Nautanki, Kachchhi Ghodi (Rajasthani baraats) |
| **Chandigarh** | **No indigenous form** — shared Punjab-Haryana capital. Culture is **Punjabi-Haryanvi**: Bhangra, Giddha, Jhumar, Luddi, Sammi, Kikli |

## WEST INDIA

### Gujarat

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Garba** ☆ | Folk/Ritual circle | Statewide; **Navaratri**, goddess Durga/Ambaji | **UNESCO ICH — Dec 2023**. From Sanskrit *garbha* = **"womb"** (life/gestation); danced around a *garbo* clay lamp-pot |
| **Dandiya Raas** ☆ | Folk | Navaratri | Energetic dance with **bamboo sticks**; concentric circles |
| Garbi | Folk | Originally **men** celebrating victorious armies | Male counterpart of Garba |
| Tippani | Folk/Labour | **Chorwad women labourers**, Saurashtra coast | Uses long sticks (*tippani*) for beating floors — a **work-rhythm** dance |
| Padhar | Folk | **Padhar** community near Nal Lake | Simulates **mariners and sea waves** |
| Siddi Dhamal | Tribal | **Siddi (Afro-Indian)** community, Jambur/Junagadh | **African-origin** drum dance; coconut-cracking on the head |
| Hudo | Folk | **Bharwad (shepherd)** community, Saurashtra | Paired clapping dance imitating **rams butting** |
| Bhavai | Folk theatre | North Gujarat | Folk drama with dance & satire |
| Rasada · Dangi | Folk/Tribal | Dangi = Adivasis of **Dangs district** | Rasada = large-circle Raas |

## Maharashtra

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Lavani** ☆ | Folk song-dance | Flourished under **Peshwa** patronage (18th–19th c.) | From *lavanya* = beauty; danced to the **dholki**; **nauvari** nine-yard sari draped pants-style. Forms: *Phadachi* (public) & *Baithakichi* (private). **NOT an SNA classical dance** |
| **Tamasha** ☆ | Folk theatre | Kolhati, Mahar, Mang communities; **Peshwa era** | Persian *tamasha* = "a show". Roles: **Nachya** (dancer), **Shahir** (poet), **Songadya** (comic). Lavani is a main section |
| Koli | Folk | **Koli fisherfolk**, Konkan/Mumbai | Mimics **rowing and net-casting**; two rows |
| Lezim | Folk/Drill | Rural; **Ganeshotsav**, village jatras, schools | Named for the **lezim** (wooden idiophone with jingling discs); more a **vigorous drill/exercise** than a dance |
| Tarpa | **Tribal** | **Warli** tribe; Palghar/Thane; harvest | Circle around the **tarpa player** — he is the *snake charmer*, dancers the *snake*; **never turn their backs to him**; sunset to dawn |
| Bohada | **Tribal/Masked** | Kokna, Warli, Mahadev Koli; Thane/Nashik | Masked dance of deities & mythological figures |
| Dhangari Gaja | Folk | **Dhangar (shepherd)**, Sholapur; deity **Biroba** | Dancers circle the drummers |
| Povada | **Ballad/Heroic** | Shahirs | Narrates the exploits of **Shivaji Maharaj** |
| Gondhal | Ritual | **Gondhali** community; goddess **Renuka/Amba** | Night invocation with **tuntune** & sambal |
| Dashavatara | Folk theatre | Konkan/Sindhudurg; temple festivals | Enacts the **10 avatars of Vishnu**; oldest Marathi theatre |
| Dindi & Kala | Devotional | **Varkari** pilgrims; Vitthal, Ekadashi | Mridang & manjira |
| Dahikala · Gouricha · Mauni | Folk | Dahikala at **Dahi Handi** | |

## Goa

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Fugdi** ☆ | Folk (women) | Women; **Dhalo** & before **Ganesha** at Ganesh Chaturthi | **No instruments** — only clapping & singing; variants: **Kalashi** (water pots), **Katti** (coconut shells), **Nagdi** (ritual vow). Competitive — whoever lasts longest wins |
| Dhalo | Folk/Ritual (women) | **Pausha** month, over 7 nights | Invokes mother-earth for family prosperity; two facing rows |
| **Shigmo** ☆ | Festival | Hindu community; **full moon of Phalguna** (~March) | Goa's spring festival; includes **Talgadi, Goff, Ghode Modni**; Dhol & Taso carried door-to-door |
| Ghode Modni | **Martial/Equestrian** | Shigmo | **Dummy-horse warrior dance** commemorating **Maratha cavalry** victories |
| Dekhnni | Folk (semi-classical) | Fusion form | Blends **Indian melody with Western/Portuguese rhythm**; song "*Hanv Saiba Poltoddi Vetam*" |
| Mando | Folk/Ballroom | **Goan Catholic**; weddings | Slow, dignified **love ballad-dance**; couples with fans; Konkani |
| Corridinho | Folk | Goan Catholic | Fast **Portuguese-origin** couple dance |
| Goff | Folk | Shigmo | Dancers **braid and unbraid coloured cords** from a pole |
| Kunbi | **Tribal** | **Kunbi** tribe — Goa's **earliest settlers** | Brisk dance; knotted Kunbi saree |
| Jagar | Ritual (all-night) | Temple deity worship | "Awakening" — all-night dance-drama of gods & demons |
| Musal Khel | Folk | **Chandor**, Salcete; Shigmo | "**Pestle dance**" commemorating a Kadamba victory |
| Talgadi · Ranmale · Tarangamel · Dhangar · Morulo | Folk | Shigmo | Tarangamel = **flags & streamers** by youth |

## Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tarpa Nach** ☆ | **Tribal** | **Warli, Kokna, Dhodia** tribes (DNH); harvest | The UT's **signature dance**; circle around the **tarpa player** (snake-charmer imagery); **sunset to dawn**; tarpa = gourd/bamboo wind instrument |
| Dhol Nach | Tribal | **Warli**; marriages & festivals | To the large **dhol** |
| Bhavada (Bohada) | **Tribal/Masked ritual** | Warli & Kokna; temple festivals | Masked gods, demons, animals |
| Gherya | Tribal/Festival | **Holi** | Men dance house-to-house |
| Ghangal | Tribal/Shamanic | Warli; the **Bhagat** (shaman-priest) | Instrument of **gourd, bamboo & iron strings** |
| Tur / Thali Nach · Mata Nach · Veradi Nach | Tribal | Kokna/Warli | Tur = drum, Thali = brass plate |
| **Daman & Diu:** Mando, Verdigo, **Garba/Dandiya**, Fugdi | Folk | Catholic + Gujarati-speaking population | Portuguese-derived + Gujarati mainstream forms |

# ▲ SOUTH INDIA

## Tamil Nadu

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bharatanatyam** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | Temple origin; statewide | Formerly ***Sadir/Dasi Attam***; formalised by the **Thanjavur Quartet**. Name parses as *bha*(bhavam) + *ra*(ragam) + *ta*(talam). **Banned by the British in 1910**; revived by **Rukmini Devi Arundale** (founded Kalakshetra) & **Balasaraswati**. Debut = ***Arangetram***; ankle bells = *salangai* |
| Karakattam | Folk/Ritual | Village festivals; goddess **Mariamman** | Balances a decorated **water pot (*karakam*)** on the head |
| Kavadi Attam | Folk/Ritual | Devotees of **Murugan**; **Thaipusam** | Performed carrying the ***kavadi*** burden as a vow-offering |
| Kummi | Folk (women) | Women; harvest & **Pongal** | One of the **oldest Tamil folk forms**; rhythm by **clapping**, no instruments |
| Kolattam | Folk (stick) | Women; temple festivals | Small sticks struck in rhythm |
| Oyilattam | Folk | Madurai, Tirunelveli | *Oyil* = "beauty/grace"; men in a line with handkerchiefs & ankle bells |
| Mayilattam | Folk (mimetic) | Murugan temple festivals | **Peacock dance** — costume with a working beak |
| Puliyattam | Folk (mimetic) | Village festivals | **Tiger dance**; bodies painted yellow-black, fangs & claws |
| Poikkaal Kudhirai Aattam | Folk (mimetic) | Temple festivals | "**False-legged horse dance**" — dummy horse frame at the waist |
| Thappattam / Parai Attam | Folk (drum) | Funerals, festivals | Danced to the **parai**, one of TN's oldest percussion instruments |
| Devarattam | Folk/Ritual | Kambalathu Naicker community | "**Dance of the gods**"; from ancient royal victory dances |
| Silambattam | **Martial** | Statewide | Staff-fighting art (*silambam*) as display dance |
| Therukoothu | Folk street-theatre | Draupadi Amman festivals | "**Street play**" — all-night Mahabharata episodes |

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bommalattam · Dappankuthu | Puppet/Folk | Village theatre | Bommalattam = marionette dance-drama |

## Kerala

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Kathakali** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | Story-play; 16th–17th c. | Colour-coded makeup (*chutti*): **Pachcha** (green=noble), **Kathi** (anti-hero), **Thadi** (red=villain), **Kari** (black=demon), **Minukku** (yellow=noble women). Traditionally **all-male**, night-long. Drums: **chenda, maddalam, idakka** |
| **Mohiniyattam** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | **Solo female**; *lasya* style | Named for **Mohini**, Vishnu's enchantress avatar. Plain **white/off-white kasavu sari** with gold border; gentle 8-shape swaying. Patronised by **Swathi Thirunal** |
| **Koodiyattam** ☆ | Classical Sanskrit theatre | **Chakyar** community; *koothambalam* temple theatres | **UNESCO ICH 2008** — India's *first* entry; among the **oldest living theatre traditions** |
| **Theyyam** ☆ | Ritual (deity possession) | **North Malabar** — Kannur & Kasaragod | ~**456 types**; at sacred groves (*kavus*); deity enters the performer when the ***mudi*** headgear is worn; season **Oct–May**. *Devakkoothu* = only women's Theyyam |
| Ottan Thullal | Solo satirical | Created by **Kunchan Nambiar** | "The **poor man's Kathakali**"; sharp social satire |
| Mudiyettu | Ritual dance-drama | Kali temples; after harvest | **UNESCO ICH 2010**; Kali's victory over **Darika** |
| Padayani | Ritual (mask) | Central Travancore Bhadrakali temples | Huge painted ***kolams*** (masks) of areca palm sheaths |
| Thiruvathirakali | Folk (women) | Nair women; **Thiruvathira & Onam** | Circle around a lamp; celebrates marital fidelity/Kamadeva |
| Oppana | Folk (Muslim) | **Mappila** community; weddings | Bride seated at centre; clapping + Mappila songs |
| Kolkali | Folk (stick) | Malabar; Hindu & Muslim | Circle expands/contracts as tempo rises |
| Margamkali | Folk (Christian) | **St. Thomas Syrian Christians** | Round dance around a lamp; songs on St. Thomas' mission |
| **Kalaripayattu** ☆ | **Martial art** | Kerala; 11th–12th c. | Trained in a ***kalari***; uniquely teaches **weapons before unarmed** combat; ***urumi*** flexible sword; legendarily founded by **Parashurama** |

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Parichamuttukali · Duffmuttu · Kummattikali | Folk | Kummattikali at **Onam** (Thrissur) | Kummattikali = wooden masks + grass costumes |

## Karnataka

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Yakshagana** ☆ | Semi-classical theatre | **Coastal Karnataka** — Dakshina Kannada, Udupi | Runs **dusk to dawn**; led by the **Bhagavata** (singer-director); *chande*, *maddale*; demon makeup takes **3–4 hours** |
| **Dollu Kunitha** ☆ | Folk (drum) | **Kuruba** community; Shiva/Beereshwara | Per *Halumatha Purana*, Shiva made the drum from demon **Dolla-asura's** skin; cymbal-leader at the centre |
| Bhuta Kola | Ritual (spirit worship) | **Tulunadu**; spirit shrines | Karnataka's counterpart to Kerala's **Theyyam** |
| Veeragase | Folk/Ritual | **Lingayat**; **Dasara** processions | Dedicated to **Veerabhadra**; sword + Shiva's image |
| Kamsale | Folk/Ritual | Devotees of **Male Mahadeshwara** | Danced with the *kamsale* brass cymbal-disc |
| Hulivesha (Tiger dance) | Folk (mimetic) | Coastal; **Dasara, Janmashtami** | Bodies painted as tigers; *tase* drums |
| Lambani | Tribal | **Lambani/Banjara** community | Mirror-work skirts, heavy silver jewellery |
| Gaarudi Gombe | Folk (puppet-costume) | Festivals & processions | Dancers wear **giant human-figure dummies** |
| Kolata · Kangilu · Bedara Vesha · Lingada Birana Kunitha | Folk | Kolata = stick dance | Bedara Vesha = "hunter's disguise" |

## Andhra Pradesh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Kuchipudi** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | **Kuchipudi village**, Krishna district | Village name from *Kusilava-puram* = "**village of actors**". Systematised by **Siddhendra Yogi** (17th c.), who wrote ***Bhama Kalapam***. Signature ***Tarangam*** — dancing on the rim of a **brass plate**, often balancing pots. Codified by **Vempati Chinna Satyam** |
| Vilasini Natyam | Classical-temple | Devadasi tradition | Revived by **Swapnasundari** |
| Veeranatyam | Ritual (vigorous) | **Veerabhadra**/Shiva; Veeramushti community | "**Dance of the warrior**" |
| Bhamakalapam | Dance-drama | Kuchipudi tradition | Solo dance-drama on **Satyabhama** |
| Tappeta Gullu | Folk (drum) | Srikakulam/Vizianagaram; **rain-invocation** | Drums at the waist; acrobatic; dedicated to **Ganga** |
| Butta Bommalu | Folk (mask) | **Tanuku**, West Godavari | Large **hollow basket-masks** covering head & shoulders |
| Dhimsa | Tribal | **Araku valley**; Valmiki, Bagata hill tribes | Danced in a **linked chain** |
| Lambadi | Tribal | **Banjara/Lambadi** | Mirror-and-ivory costume; harvest |
| Burrakatha | Narrative folk | Villages | Storytelling with the ***burra*** (tambura); 1 narrator + 2 co-performers |
| Kolattam · Dappu · Ghantamardala | Folk | Women/festivals | Kolattam = stick dance in circles |

## Telangana

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Perini Shivatandavam** ☆ | **Martial/Ritual (male)** | **Kakatiya dynasty**, Warangal; Shiva | "**Dance of Warriors**" — performed by **soldiers before battle** to invoke Shiva. In the *Nrttya Ratnavali*; sculpted at the **Ramappa Temple**. Revived by **Dr. Nataraja Ramakrishna** |
| **Bathukamma** ☆ | Festival (women) | **Bathukamma** — the **state floral festival** | Women circle a **conical flower-stack** honouring goddess Gauri |
| Bonalu | Festival/Ritual | **Bonalu**, Hyderabad/Secunderabad | Women carry ***bonam*** pots to **Mahankali**; ***Pothuraju*** dances ahead |
| Gussadi | Tribal | **Raj Gond**, Adilabad; **Dandari**/Diwali | **Peacock-feather headdress** |
| Oggu Katha | Narrative folk | Yadava/Kuruma priests; **Mallanna & Beerappa** | Ballad-narration with drums |
| Lambadi | Tribal | Banjara tandas | Mirror-work costume; harvest |
| Chindu Bhagavatham | Folk dance-drama | Chindu Madiga community | Travelling troupe theatre |
| Keisabadi · Dappu · Mathuri | Folk/Tribal | Keisabadi = 2-metre poles | Dappu = frame-drum, a Telangana signature |

## Puducherry & Lakshadweep

| UT | Dance Form | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **Puducherry** | **Garadi** ☆ | Puducherry's **best-known dance**; commemorates the **vanaras (monkeys) celebrating Rama's victory over Ravana**; **vanara masks**, sticks, ten chiming iron rings (*anjali*); two large **ramadolu** drums; runs **5–8 hours** |
| | Kolattam · Karakattam · Therukoothu · Villu Paatu · Mayilattam | Shared with **Tamil Nadu** |
| **Lakshadweep** | **Kolkali** ☆ | Circle, **striking small sticks**; circle expands/contracts as pitch rises |
| | **Lava** ☆ | Signature dance of **Minicoy Island**; vivid costume with drums |
| | Parichakali | Men with **swords and shields**; follows **Kalaripayattu** steps |
| | Bandiya | **Minicoy**; Maldivian-influenced; metal **water-pots (*bandiya*)** struck with rings |
| | Oppana · Attam | Shared with Kerala's Mappila tradition |

## ▼ EAST INDIA

### Odisha

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Odissi** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | Temples of Odisha; Vaishnavism | Often called the **oldest surviving classical dance**; sculpted in Kalingan temples (6th–9th c.); built on Jayadeva's ***Gita Govinda***. Two streams: **Maharis** (temple devadasis) & **Gotipuas** (boys dressed as girls). **Banned 1910**, revived by **Kelucharan Mohapatra**; **Sanjukta Panigrahi** took it global. Signature: ***Tribhanga*** posture |
| **Chhau (Mayurbhanj)** ☆ | Semi-classical/martial | **Mayurbhanj**; Chaitra Parva | The **only Chhau style using NO masks**. **UNESCO ICH 2010** |
| Gotipua | Traditional (Odissi precursor) | Boys dressed as girls | Acrobatic ***bandha nrutya*** poses |
| Mahari | Temple (devadasi) | **Jagannath Temple, Puri** | Sang the *Gita Govinda* before Jagannath |
| **Dalkhai** ☆ | Folk (women) | **Sambalpur**; **Nuakhai**, Bhaijiuntia | Name from the refrain "**Dalkhai Bo!**"; **Sambalpuri sarees**; dhol controls tempo |
| Ghumra | Folk | **Kalahandi**; Nuakhai/Dussehra | Named for the ***ghumra*** earthen pitcher-drum slung from the neck |
| Chaiti Ghoda | Folk (mimetic) | **Kaibarta (fisherman)** caste; Chaitra | **Dummy-horse** dance honouring goddess Basuli |
| Karma Naach | Tribal (harvest) | Binjhal, Kharia, Kisan; **Karma festival** | Worships **Karam Devta**, god of fate/harvest |
| Ranapa | Folk (**stilt**) | Ganjam; Krishna theme | Danced **on stilts** by cowherd boys |
| Bagha Nacha | Folk (mimetic) | Sambalpur; Chaitra Parva | **Tiger dance** — body painted with stripes |
| Danda Nata | Ritual | Chaitra; Shiva/Kali | **Penance** dance; performers undergo austerities |
| Paika · Keisabadi · Pala | Martial/Folk | Paika = warrior class | Pala = ballad-singing, **Satyapir** (Hindu-Muslim blend) |

## West Bengal

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Chhau (Purulia)** ☆ | Semi-classical/martial (**mask**) | **Purulia**; Chaitra Parva | **Large elaborate masks** shaped as the character, made by **potters** from paper & clay. **UNESCO ICH 2010** |
| **Gambhira** ☆ | Folk (mask/satire) | **Malda**; Chaitra Sankranti; Shiva | Two performers play **a man and his maternal grandfather** in dialogue; **biting satire** mocking even the powerful present |
| **Baul** ☆ | Devotional (mystic) | **Baul** minstrels; Birbhum | **UNESCO ICH**; wandering singers dance to the ***ektara*** & duggi |
| Raibenshe | **Martial** | Men | Vigorous dance of former **bodyguards/soldiers**; bamboo staves |
| Dhunuchi Naach | Ritual | **Durga Puja**, statewide | Danced holding smoking ***dhunuchi*** incense-burners; to the **dhak** drum |
| Brita | Folk (vow-fulfilment) | Women; after a vow is fulfilled | Gratitude dance, often for childbirth |
| Kushan Gaan | Narrative folk | North Bengal; Ramayana | Story of **Lava and Kusha**, Rama's sons |
| Jhumair | Folk | **Jangalmahal** (Purulia, Bankura) | Shared with Jharkhand & Odisha; harvest |
| Nacnī | Folk (professional female) | Purulia/Manbhum | Professional dancer paired with a ***rasik*** patron |
| Santhali / Dasai | Tribal | **Santhal** community | Rows to the ***madal*** drum at **Sohrai** & Dasai |
| Alkap · Domni | Folk theatre | Murshidabad, Malda, Birbhum | Comic-satirical troupe performance |

## Bihar

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Jhijhiya** ☆ | Folk/Ritual (women) | **Mithila**; **Dussehra**; goddess Durga | Women balance **perforated earthen pots with lamps inside** on their heads; performed to **ward off black magic** |
| **Jat-Jatin** ☆ | Folk (duet) | **North Bihar/Mithila**; monsoon | Enacts the **separation of a couple**, Jat & Jatin — a **migration** story |
| **Bidesiya** ☆ | Folk theatre | Created by **Bhikhari Thakur**; Bhojpur | The pain of **wives left behind by migrant labourers**. Bhikhari Thakur = "**Shakespeare of Bhojpuri**" |
| Domkach | Folk (women) | Weddings; women of the household | Performed at night **when the groom's party has left** |
| Sohar-Khilouna | Folk | Women; **childbirth** | Celebrates the birth of a child |
| Kajri | Folk (seasonal) | Women; **monsoon (Sawan)** | Songs of longing |
| Launda Naach | Folk | Bhojpuri; weddings | **Male dancers in female attire**; linked to Bidesiya troupes |
| Jhumair · Paika · Phagua/Jogira · Jhumri | Folk/Martial | Phagua at **Holi** | |

## Jharkhand

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Chhau (Seraikella)** ☆ | Semi-classical/martial (**mask**) | **Seraikella**; Chaitra Parva | Uses **symbolic masks** that establish the role (unlike Purulia's character-masks). **UNESCO ICH 2010** |
| **Jhumair** ☆ | Folk (harvest) | Community; harvest season | Jharkhand's **signature folk dance**; madal, nagara, shehnai |
| Mardani Jhumar / Janani Jhumar | Folk | Men / Women | The **masculine** vs **feminine** variants |
| **Karma** ☆ | Tribal (harvest) | **Oraon, Munda, Ho**; **Karma festival** (Bhadra) | Danced around a **Karam tree branch**; honours **Karam Devta**, god of fate & fertility |
| Santhali / Sohrai | Tribal | **Santhal**; **Sohrai** (post-harvest cattle festival) | Linked rows to ***madal*** & tumdak |
| Domkach | Folk (women) | Weddings | Danced at the bride's/groom's home |
| Paiki | **Martial** | Warrior tradition | Acrobatic sword-and-shield; **feeds into Chhau** |
| Nacnī · Firkal · Fagua | Folk | Fagua at Holi | Nacnī shared with Purulia |

## Andaman & Nicobar Islands

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Nicobarese Ossuary Feast dance** ☆ | Tribal (ritual) | **Nicobarese**; funerary/ancestor rites | The islands' **best-known indigenous dance** |
| Pig Festival dance (*Panuohonot*) | Tribal | **Chowra Island**; onset of **north-east winds** | **3-week festival** in memory of ancestors; closes with a **canoe race** |
| Chicken Festival dance (*Kancheuollo*) | Tribal | Nicobarese; onset of **south-west winds** | |
| Nicobari (Hodi) dance | Tribal | **Car Nicobar**; festivals | Named after the ***hodi*** canoe; **coconut-leaf costume** |
| Jarawa · Onge · Great Andamanese dances | Tribal | Negrito tribes | Onge/Great Andamanese keep rhythm by striking a wooden **sounding board with the foot** |
| Settler dances (Jhumair, Kolattam, Baul) | Folk (migrant) | Mainland settler communities | The islands' living dance culture is largely **mainland-derived** |

## ◆ NORTHEAST INDIA

### Assam

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Sattriya** ☆ | **Classical (SNA, recognised 2000)** | **Sattra** monasteries; Vaishnavite | Created by **Srimanta Sankardeva** (16th c.); **newest** classical dance; accompanied by the ***khol*** drum, bhortal cymbals & ***bargeet*** songs; pat/muga silk costume |
| **Bihu** ☆ | Folk/Harvest | Assamese; **Rongali (Bohag) Bihu**, spring | The state's **signature dance**; vigorous hip & arm movements; **dhol, pepa** (buffalo-horn pipe), gogona, taal |
| **Bagurumba** ☆ | Folk/Tribal | **Bodo (Boro)** tribe | The "**butterfly dance**" — mimics butterflies & birds; **women only**; dokhona costume; kham drum, sifung flute |
| Jhumur | Folk/Tribal | **Tea-tribes/Adivasi** of the tea gardens | Girls in **linked rows** to the madal — hallmark of the tea-garden community |
| Deodhani | Ritual/Trance | **Kamakhya** temple; goddess **Manasa** | **Trance dance** by a woman possessed by the deity |
| Ankiya Bhaona | Ritual dance-drama | Sattra institutions | **Sankardeva's one-act plays** — the form Sattriya draws from |
| Maharas / Rasleela | Ritual | Vaishnavite, **Majuli** | Krishna-Radha; on **Kartik Purnima** |
| Bohuwa | Folk/Tribal | **Sonowal Kachari** tribe | At the Bohuwa festival |
| Khel Gopal · Kaligopal · Natpuja · Bichhua · Tabal Chongli | Folk/Ritual | Vaishnavite | Krishna-themed group dances |

## Manipur

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Manipuri (Jagoi/Raas Leela)** ☆ | **Classical (SNA)** | **Meitei**; Krishna-Radha devotion | **Gentlest** of classical forms; women wear the barrel-shaped stiff skirt ***Potloi (Kumil)*** with mirror-work; men as Krishna wear a **peacock-feather crown**; ***pung***, kartal, flute |
| 5 Raas types: **Maharas** (Kartik full moon), **Basanta Raas** (spring/Holi), **Kunja Raas** (autumn), **Nitya Raas**, **Diba Raas** (daytime) | Classical | Seasonal Raas Leelas | Exam trap: **5 accepted Raas Leelas** |
| **Pung Cholom** ☆ | Folk/Devotional | Meitei **men** | **Drum dance** — dancers play the *pung* while **leaping and spinning**; opens Sankirtana |
| **Lai Haraoba** ☆ | Ritual/Fertility | Meitei; pre-Vaishnavite **Umang Lai** worship | "**Merrymaking of the gods**"; re-enacts **creation**; led by ***maibas/maibis*** (priests/priestesses) |
| **Thang Ta** ☆ | **Martial** | Meitei warriors | ***Thang*** = sword, ***ta*** = spear; Manipur's martial art turned performance |
| Kartal Cholom | Devotional | Meitei; **Sankirtana** | Cymbal dance; part of **UNESCO-listed Sankirtana (2013)** |
| Khamba Thoibi | Folk/Ritual | **Moirang**; deity **Thangjing** | Duet on the **Khamba-Thoibi love legend** |
| Nupa Pala · Khubak Ishei · Maibi Jagoi | Folk/Ritual | Meitei | Maibi Jagoi = trance dance by priestesses |

## Meghalaya

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Ka Shad Suk Mynsiem** ☆ | Folk/Thanksgiving | **Khasi**; April, Shillong | "**Dance of the joyful heart**"; **unmarried girls dance inward, men in an outer circle**; harvest & fertility thanksgiving |
| **Ka Shad Nongkrem** ☆ | Ritual/Harvest | **Khasi**, **Smit** village; autumn | **5-day Nongkrem festival**; goat sacrifice (*Pomblang*) to goddess **Ka Blei Synshar**; presided over by the **Syiem of Khyrim** |
| **Wangala** ☆ | Tribal/Harvest | **Garo**; Sept–Dec, Asanang | "**Hundred Drums Festival**"; thanksgiving to sun god **Misi Saljong**; long oval ***dama*** drums; **Dama Gogata** on the last day |
| Behdienkhlam | Ritual | **Jaintia (Pnar)**, Jowai; July | Chasing away **plague/evil spirits**; men dance in **muddy pools**; tall decorated ***rots*** |
| Laho | Folk/Recreation | **Jaintia**; Behdienkhlam | A woman **links arms with two men**; accompanied not by drums but a **cheerleader reciting couplets** |
| Doregata | Folk | **Garo**; Wangala | Women try to **knock off the men's turbans with their heads** |
| Chambil Mesara | Folk | **Garo** | "**Pomelo dance**" — dancers swing a pomelo tied at the waist |
| Shad Sukra · Ka Shad Mastieh · Do'kru Sua | Ritual/Martial | Khasi/Garo | Mastieh = mock-fight with **sword and shield** |

## Mizoram

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cheraw** ☆ | Folk/**Bamboo** | **Mizo**; **Chapchar Kut**, weddings | Mizoram's most famous dance — men tap **bamboo staves**, women step between. **Guinness record 2010: 10,736 dancers** over 3 km in Aizawl |
| Khuallam | Folk/Guest | Mizo; **Khuangchawi** ceremony | "**Dance of the guests**"; draped in the ***puandum*** cloth; gong-driven |
| Chai | Folk/Festival | Mizo; **Chapchar Kut** | Men & women **alternate in a circle**, hands on waists/shoulders |
| Chheihlam | Folk/Recreation | Mizo; evening entertainment | Around a singer to the "*chheih*" chant; born under **British confinement** |
| Sarlamkai | Folk/**Victory** | Mailam/Pawi & Mara | After a successful **head-hunting raid**; gongs & cymbals, **no singing** |
| Chawnglaizawn | Folk | **Pawi** community | Performed by **bereaved husbands** and at harvest |
| Par Lam | Folk/Flower | Mizo | "**Flower dance**" — modern Christian-era adaptation |
| Tlanglam · Zangtalam · Rallu Lam · Khanatm | Folk | Tlanglam = most performed on modern stages | Rallu Lam = warrior's dance after a hunt |

## Nagaland

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Rangma (War Dance)** ☆ | Tribal/**Martial** | **Angami** tribe; **Sekrenyi** festival | Warrior's dance in **full battle gear** — spear, *dao* & shield; loud **war cries** |
| Aaluyattu | Tribal/War | **Konyak** tribe; **Aoleang** festival | Warrior dance of the **tattooed-face Konyaks** |
| Changai / Modse | Tribal/War | **Ao** tribe; **Moatsu** festival | Victory & warrior dance |
| Zeliang | Tribal | **Zeliang** tribe | Showcased at the **Hornbill Festival** |
| Temangnetin / Hetaleulee | Tribal | **Chang** tribe | Men's / Women's dances |
| Nsuirolians (**Cock Dance**) | Tribal | **Chakhesang** tribe | Imitates a **cock fight** |
| Butterfly Dance | Tribal | **Konyak** tribe | Mimics butterfly movements |
| Leshalaptu | Tribal | **Sumi** tribe; **Tuluni** festival | Harvest-time dance |
| Kuki / Bamboo Dance | Tribal/Bamboo | **Kuki** tribe | Bamboo-pole dance similar to Mizo **Cheraw** |
| Sadal Kekai · Seecha & Kukui Kucho · Gethinglim | Tribal | Zeliang | |

## Tripura

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hojagiri** ☆ | Folk/**Balancing** | **Reang (Bru)** clan; **Laxmi Puja** (Hojagiri) | Tripura's **most famous** dance; 4–6 young women balance an **earthen pitcher/bottle on the head and lamps on the hands**, moving **only the lower half** of the body |
| **Garia** ☆ | Tribal/Ritual | **Tripuri, Reang**; **Garia Puja** (April) | Danced around the **Garia bamboo pole deity** for a good harvest & cattle wealth |
| Jhum / Lebang Boomani | Tribal/Harvest | **Tripuri**; after jhum harvest | Celebrates catching colourful ***lebang* insects**; **bamboo clappers** |
| Mamita | Tribal/Harvest | Tripuri; Mamita festival | New-harvest thanksgiving |
| Bizhu | Tribal/New Year | **Chakma**; Chaitra Sankranti | End-of-year festival dance |
| Sangrai | Tribal | **Mog** community; Sangrai/Boisu New Year | Buddhist Mog **water-festival** dance |
| Hai-Hak | Tribal/Harvest | **Halam** community | Post-harvest thanksgiving to Laxmi |
| Wangala · Owa · Gajan | Tribal/Folk | Garo community of Tripura; Bengali Gajan (Shiva) | |

## Arunachal Pradesh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bardo Chham** ☆ | Ritual/**Mask** | **Sherdukpen** tribe; West Kameng | "**Bardo**" = the limbo between death & rebirth (Tibetan Book of the Dead); **wooden animal masks**; triumph of good over evil |
| **Ponung** ☆ | Folk/Harvest | **Adi** tribe; **Solung** festival | Women circle a male ***Miri*** (priest-singer) holding a sword-like *yoksha* |
| Aji Lhamu | Ritual/Mask | **Monpa** tribe | Masked dance-drama with religious & social themes |
| Chham (Losar Chham) | Ritual/Monastic | **Monpa**; **Tawang Monastery**, Losar | Buddhist **lama mask dance** |
| Wancho Dance | Tribal/War | **Wancho** tribe; **Oriah** festival | Warrior dance of the **tattooed Wanchos** |
| Popir | Folk/Harvest | **Adi (Padam-Minyong)**; Solung | Women's harvest dance |
| Rikham Pada / Roppi / Buiya | Folk | **Nyishi** — the **largest Arunachali tribe**; **Nyokum** festival | |
| Hiirii Khaniing | Folk | **Apatani** tribe; **Dree** festival | Apatani agricultural festival |
| Chalo | Folk | **Nocte** tribe; **Loku** festival | Nocte harvest festival |
| Lion & Peacock Dance | Folk/Mask | **Monpa**; **Losar** New Year | Tibetan Buddhist influence |
| Igo · Pasi Kongki | Ritual/Folk | **Mishmi** priests (Igu); Adi | Igo = shamanic priest dance |

## Sikkim

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Singhi Chham** ☆ | Ritual/**Mask** | **Bhutia**; **Pang Lhabsol** | The **snow lion dance** — white costume with bluish mane, **2 dancers per lion**; honours **Mt. Kanchenjunga**, whose peaks resemble the snow lion; introduced by **Chador Namgyal, 3rd Chogyal** |
| Chaam | Ritual/Monastic | Buddhist lamas; **Losar, Pang Lhabsol** | Masked lama dance, good over evil |
| **Maruni** ☆ | Folk | **Nepali** community; **Tihar/Diwali** | Sikkim's **most popular Nepali folk dance**; led by the clown ***Dhatu Waray***; naumati baja ensemble |
| Chu Faat | Ritual | **Lepcha**; honours **Mt. Kanchenjunga** | With **butter lamps** and green bamboo leaves |
| Yak Chham | Folk/Mask | Bhutia/Tibetan herders | Depicts the **yak**, lifeline of the mountain people |
| Khukuri Naach | Folk/**Martial** | **Nepali (Gorkha)** | Performed with the ***khukuri*** (curved Gorkha knife) |
| Zo Mal Lok | Folk/Harvest | **Lepcha** | Joy of harvesting & paddy work |
| Tashi Yangku · Denzong Gnenha · Lu Khangthamo · Rechungma · Chutkey · Sikmari | Folk | Bhutia/Nepali | Lu Khangthamo = thanksgiving to gods of the **4 directions** |

## 🔷 CENTRAL INDIA

### Madhya Pradesh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tertali (Tera Tali)** ☆ | Folk/Ritual | **Kamar** tribe; worship of **Baba Ramdev** | **Seated women** tie ***manjiras*** **(cymbals) to 13 points** on the body and strike them with brass discs; sometimes balancing a pot with a **sword in the teeth** |
| **Gaur Maria** ☆ | Tribal/Hunting | **Maria Gond** tribe | Men wear **bison-horn headgear (*gaur*)** with cowrie shells; women with brass anklets |
| Maanch | Folk theatre | **Malwa** region | MP's classic **folk opera**; songs called ***zikri***; developed in the **17th century** |
| Matki | Folk (women) | **Malwa**; weddings | Solo woman balancing an earthen ***matki*** on the head, **face veiled** |
| Jawara | Folk/Harvest | **Bundelkhand** | Women balance baskets of ***jawara*** **(wheat sprouts)** on their heads |
| Grida | Folk/Harvest | **Nimar/Malwa**; when the rabi crop ripens | Danced **in the fields**; 3 stages — Sela, Selalarki, Selabhadoni |
| Bhagoria | Tribal/**Courtship** | **Bhil & Bhilala**; **Bhagoria Haat** before Holi | Famous "**elopement**" festival where couples choose partners |
| Rai | Folk | Bundelkhand; **Bedni** women | Fast dance to the mridang; the region's **most popular** folk dance |
| Karma | Tribal | **Gond, Baiga, Oraon**; Karma festival | Around the sacred **karam tree** after the rains |
| Baredi · Ahirai · Saila · Badhai · Phulpati · Lehangi | Folk | Baredi/Ahirai at **Diwali** (cowherds) | Saila = stick dance, often **on one leg** |

### Chhattisgarh

| Dance Form | Category | Community / Occasion | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Panthi** ☆ | Folk/Devotional | **Satnami** community; **Maghi Purnima** — birth anniversary of **Guru Ghasidas** | Chhattisgarh's best-known dance; men in white building **acrobatic human pyramids**; the white ***Jaitkhamb*** pillar is central |
| **Pandavani** ☆ | Folk narrative | **Mahabharata** tales centred on **Bhima** | Two styles: **Vedamati** (seated, classical) & **Kapalik** (free improvisation — **Teejan Bai**); performed with an ***ektara/tambura*** decorated with bells & peacock feathers |
| **Raut Nacha** ☆ | Folk/Devotional | **Raut (Yadav)** community; **Dev Uthni Ekadashi** | Worship of **Krishna**; celebrates the **awakening of the gods**; sticks & peacock-feather adornment |
| Gaur Maria | Tribal | **Maria Gond**, **Bastar** | **Bison-horn headdresses**; a Bastar icon |
| Karma | Tribal/Seasonal | **Gond, Baiga, Oraon**; onset of rains | Around the **karam tree branch**; mandar & timki |
| Suwa | Folk (women) | Women; **Diwali** season | The "**parrot dance**" — women circle a basket with a **wooden parrot** (Shiva-Parvati); **clapping, no instruments** |
| Saila | Folk/Stick | Sarguja, Raigarh; post-harvest | Young men with sticks, **hopping on one leg** |
| Chandaini | Folk narrative | Chhattisgarh | Ballad of the lovers **Lorik and Chanda** |
| Bharthari Charit | Folk narrative | Chhattisgarh | Legend of **King Bharthari** of Ujjain |
| Jhumar · Goudi · Diwari · Mundari · Dagla/Pali | Folk/Tribal | Diwari at Diwali (Raut) | |

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# 🧠 PART 4 — MEMORY TRICKS & MNEMONICS

> **This is the section that makes Part 3 stick.** For each state: an **acronym key** (first letters of the must-know dances) + a **story hook** that ties the acronym to the state. Read the story once, picture it, and the dances come back.

> 🎯 **How to revise:** Cover Part 3 → read only the acronym → try to expand it → check. Do this 3 times and the state is locked.

## 4.1 THE BIG PICTURE — Master Hooks First

### 🔑 Hook 1: The 8 Classical Dances → States

> **"BhaKa-KaKu-OdMa-MoSa"** — say it as a rhythm (like a tabla bol!)

| Acronym bit | Dance | State |
|---|---|---|
| **Bha** | **Bha**ratanatyam | **Tamil Nadu** |
| **Ka** | **Ka**thak | **Uttar Pradesh** |
| **Ka** | **Ka**thakali | **Kerala** |
| **Ku** | **Ku**chipudi | **Andhra Pradesh** |
| **Od** | **Od**issi | **Odisha** |
| **Ma** | **Ma**nipuri | **Manipur** |
| **Mo** | **Mo**hiniyattam | **Kerala** (2nd!) |
| **Sa** | **Sa**ttriya | **Assam** |

> 📖 **Story:** "***Bha****rat and* ***Ka****ka went to* ***Ka****thmandu to eat* ***Ku****lfi.* ***Od****d* ***Ma****n* ***Mo****han* ***Sa****id no.*"

> 🎯 **Self-check trio:** Manipuri→**Man**ipur, Odissi→**Od**isha, Sattriya→**Sa**tra(Assam) — these three **name themselves**. Kuchipudi is a **village in AP**. So only **4 are truly arbitrary**: Bharatanatyam(TN), Kathak(UP), Kathakali+Mohiniyattam(Kerala).

### 🔑 Hook 2: The 3 UNESCO Dances

> **"C-K-G"** → "***C****an* ***K****ids* ***G****arba?*"

> **Chhau** (Odisha/WB/Jharkhand, 2010) · **Kalbelia** (Rajasthan, 2010) · **Garba** (Gujarat, **2023**)

> 🎯 *Chhau & Kalbelia are twins — both* ***2010****. Garba is the newcomer —* ***2023****.*

### 🔑 Hook 3: The 4 Instrument Families

> **"TSAG"** = **T**ata(string) · **S**ushira(wind) · **A**vanaddha(skin/drum) · **G**hana(solid)

> 📖 **Story:** "***T**ake **S**ome **A**mazing **G**hatam*" — and Ghatam **is** the Ghana example!

> 🎯 *Avanaddha = "**A**" for "**A**njali claps a **drum**skin"; Ghana = "**G**" for "**G**hatam/**G**hungroo — no skin, solid body".*

### 🔑 Hook 4: Which state has TWO classical dances?

> **KERALA** = **Ka**thakali + **Mo**hiniyattam.

> 📖 *"Kerala is **K**ing — it gets **2**."* Every other state gets exactly one.

## 4.2 STATE-BY-STATE: Acronym + Story

### 🔷 NORTH

**RAJASTHAN — "GK-BC-CG"** → "***G**eneral **K**nowledge **B**ook **C**osts **C**rores of **G**old*"

> **G**hoomar · **K**albelia · **B**havai · **C**hari · **C**hakri · **G**angaur

> 📖 **Story:** A **Rajput queen twirls (Ghoomar)** while a **snake charmer (Kalbelia)** plays; she balances **pots (Bhavai)** with **lamps (Chari)**, then **whirls (Chakri)** at the **Gangaur** festival.

> 🎯 **Pot pair: Bhavai = many pots, Chari = pots with LAMPS**. *"Cha**ri** = **ri**ght, it's lit!"*

**PUNJAB — "BiG-JLS"** → "***Big** **J**olly **L**ively **S**tate*"

> **B**hangra · **G**iddha · **J**humar · **L**uddi · **S**ammi

> 📖 **Story:** Punjab is **BIG** and jolly — **men do Bhangra with the dhol**, **women do Giddha with claps** (no drum!).

> 🎯 **The pair to never mix: Bhangra = men + DHOL · Giddha = women + CLAPS**. *"**G**iddha = **G**irls"*.

**HARYANA — "GLP-KD"** → "***G**irls **L**ove **P**laying **K**abaddi **D**aily*" (Haryana = kabaddi land!)

> **G**hoomar · **L**oor · **P**haag · **K**horia · **D**hamal

> 📖 **Story:** In Haryana, girls dance **Loor** at Holi, **Khoria** at weddings **when the baraat leaves**, and **Dhamal** on full-moon nights.

> 🎯 *Loor = **l**aughter of a **daughter** (lur = daughter).*

**HIMACHAL — "NT"** → "***N**ati **T**hoda*" → "***N**ot **T**oday*"

> **N**ati (Guinness — 9,892 women!) · **T**hoda (archery/martial)

> 📖 **Story:** In the **hills**, 9,892 women danced **Nati** at Kullu Dussehra (**Guinness**); the men shot blunt arrows in **Thoda**.

> 🎯 *Tho**da** = **da**nger = archery. **Nati = Number** (Guinness number!)*

**UTTAR PRADESH — "K-C-R-N"** → "***K**athak **C**harkula **R**aslila **N**autanki*" → "***K**rishna **C**arries **R**adha **N**ightly*" (all Braj/Krishna themed!)

> **K**athak · **C**harkula · **R**aslila · **N**autanki

> 📖 **Story:** UP = **Braj = Krishna land**. **Kathak** came from **Kathakars (storytellers)**; **Charkula** women carry **108 lamps** for **Radha's birth**; **Raslila** is Krishna's dance; **Nautanki** is the folk opera.

> 🎯 **Charkula = 108 lamps + ~50 kg.** "*Char-**kula** = **coo**l, 108 lamps!*"

**UTTARAKHAND — "CJ-CL"** → "***C**hholiya **J**hora **C**hhapeli **L**angvir*"

> 📖 **Story:** A **sword dance (Chholiya)** leads the **baraat**; then **Langvir** — a man balances **on a pole on his navel**!

> 🎯 **Chholiya = sword + wedding. Langvir = pole acrobat.** "***Lang** = **long** pole*".

**J&K — "RDK-B"** → "***R**ouf **D**umhal **K**ud **B**hand*" → "***R**eally **D**on't **K**now **B**etter*"

> 📖 **Story:** Kashmiri **women link arms (Rouf)**; only the **Wattal men** dance **Dumhal** in **tall conical caps** around a **planted banner**; **Bhand Pather** = satire.

> 🎯 **Dumhal = Wattal tribe, MEN ONLY, conical cap + banner.** "***Dum**hal = **dum** (only men have the dum!)*"

**LADAKH — "CSJ"** → "***C**ham **S**hondol **J**abro*" → "***C**old **S**now **J**ourney*"

> 📖 **Story:** Monks in **masks (Cham)** dance the **Black Hat** dance — killing tyrant king **Langdarma**; the **King's own Shondol**; nomads dance **Jabro**.

> 🎯 **Cham = Padmasambhava + Langdarma.** *Wrongly called "devil dance".*

## 🔶 WEST

**GUJARAT — "GD-GT-P-S"** → "***G**arba **D**andiya **G**arbi **T**ippani **P**adhar **S**iddi*"

> 📖 **Story: Navaratri** — **Garba** (circle round the *garbo* **lamp-pot**; *garbha* = **womb**) → **Dandiya** (sticks) → **Garbi** (men). Then coastal: **Tippani** (women beat floors), **Padhar** (sea waves), **Siddi Dhamal** (African-origin!).

> 🎯 **Garba = UNESCO 2023 + "womb". Siddi = Afro-Indian.**

**MAHARASHTRA — "LT-KL-TP"** → "***L**avani **T**amasha **K**oli **L**ezim **T**arpa **P**ovada*"

> 📖 **Story: Lavani** (nauvari sari, dholki) is a section **inside Tamasha** (Peshwa-era theatre); **Koli** fisherfolk **row and cast nets**; **Lezim** is a **drill**; **Warli tribe** circles the **Tarpa player** (snake-charmer!); **Povada** sings of **Shivaji**.

> 🎯 **Lavani lives inside Tamasha. Povada = Shivaji. Tarpa = Warli.**

**GOA — "F-D-S-G"** → "***F**ugdi **D**halo **S**higmo **G**hode Modni*" → "***F**un **D**ays **S**pent in **G**oa*"

> 📖 **Story:** Goan women clap **Fugdi** (**no instruments!**) and **Dhalo**; at **Shigmo** (spring), men ride **dummy horses (Ghode Modni)** for Maratha victories; Catholics dance **Mando** (slow love ballad).

> 🎯 **Fugdi = NO instruments. Mando = Catholic/Portuguese. Shigmo = Goa's Holi.**

## 🔺 SOUTH

**TAMIL NADU — "B-K³-M-P-O"** → "***B**haratanatyam + the 3 K's + animals*"

> **B**haratanatyam · **K**arakattam · **K**avadi · **K**ummi · **K**olattam · **M**ayilattam · **P**uliyattam · **O**yilattam

> 📖 **Story: Bharatanatyam** (banned 1910, revived by **Rukmini Devi**) is the queen. Then the **pot (Karakattam)**, the **vow-burden (Kavadi/Murugan)**, **clapping (Kummi)**, **sticks (Kolattam)**. The **animals**: **Mayil**=peacock , **Puli**=tiger , **Poikkaal Kudhirai**=horse .

> 🎯 **Animal trick:** *Mayil = **mayil** is Tamil for peacock; Puli = **puli** is tiger.* Learn the Tamil word = learn the dance!

**KERALA — "K-M-K-T-O-K"** → "***K**athakali **M**ohiniyattam **K**oodiyattam **T**heyyam **O**ttan Thullal **K**alaripayattu*"

> 📖 **Story:** Kerala = **2 classicals** (**Kathakali** = green-faced men at night; **Mohiniyattam** = solo woman in **white kasavu**). **Koodiyattam** = UNESCO **2008, India's FIRST**. **Theyyam** = **deity possesses** the dancer (~456 types, North Malabar). **Ottan Thullal** = "**poor man's Kathakali**" by **Kunchan Nambiar**. **Kalaripayattu** = weapons **before**

unarmed.

🎯 **Kathakali colours: Pachcha**=green=noble · **Kathi**=anti-hero · **Thadi**=red=villain · **Kari**=black=demon · **Minukku**=yellow=women.

🎯 "***Mohini*** = *enchantress* = ***solo woman in white***."

**KARNATAKA — "Y-D-V-B"** → "***Y****akshagana* ***D****ollu* ***V****eeragase* ***B****huta Kola*" → "***Y****ou* ***D****on't* ***V****isit* ***B****engaluru?*"

📖 **Story: Yakshagana** runs **dusk to dawn** (coastal); **Dollu Kunitha** = **Kuruba** drum dance (drum from demon **Dolla-asura's** skin!); **Veeragase** = Lingayat, **Veerabhadra**, Dasara; **Bhuta Kola** = Karnataka's **Theyyam**.

🎯 **Bhuta Kola (Karnataka) ↔ Theyyam (Kerala)** — twin spirit-worship dances.

**ANDHRA — "K-V-B-D-L"** → "***K****uchipudi* ***V****eeranatyam* ***B****urrakatha* ***D****himsa* ***L****ambadi*"

📖 **Story: Kuchipudi** = a **village** ("village of actors") → **Siddhendra Yogi** → dance on a **brass plate (Tarangam)**! **Burrakatha** = storytelling with the **burra**; **Dhimsa** = Araku tribes.

🎯 **Kuchipudi = brass PLATE + pot on head.** "*Ku-chi-****pudi*** = ***plate****-ee!*"

**TELANGANA — "P-B-B-G"** → "***P****erini* ***B****athukamma* ***B****onalu* ***G****ussadi*"

📖 **Story: Perini Shivatandavam** = **Kakatiya WARRIORS** danced it **before battle** (Ramappa Temple!) — revived by **Nataraja Ramakrishna**. **Bathukamma** = **flower stack** (state festival); **Bonalu** = **pots to Mahankali**.

🎯 **Perini = "Dance of Warriors" = Kakatiya = Warangal.**

## ▼ EAST

**ODISHA — "O-C-G-D-G"** → "***O****dissi* ***C****hhau* ***G****otipua* ***D****alkhai* ***G****humra*"

📖 **Story: Odissi** = **Tribhanga** (3-bend), from **Maharis** (temple) & **Gotipuas** (boys as girls); **Mayurbhanj Chhau = the only Chhau with NO mask**; **Dalkhai** = Sambalpur ("**Dalkhai Bo!**"); **Ghumra** = pitcher-drum; **Ranapa** = **stilts**.

🎯 **CHHAU MASK TRICK: M**ayurbhanj = **M**askless! · Purulia = character masks · Seraikella = symbolic masks.

📖 "***Ma****yurbhanj has* ***Ma*** *mask?* ***NA!***"

**WEST BENGAL — "C-G-B-D-R"** → "***C**hhau **G**ambhira **B**aul **D**hunuchi **R**aibenshe*"

> 📖 **Story: Purulia Chhau** = **big character masks** (made by **potters**); **Gambhira** = a man + his **maternal grandfather** trading **satire**; **Baul** = UNESCO mystic minstrels with **ektara**; **Dhunuchi** = **incense burners** at Durga Puja.

> 🎯 **Gambhira = grandfather + satire (Malda).** "***Gam**bhira = **Gran**dpa!*"

**BIHAR — "J-J-B-D"** → "***J**hijhiya **J**at-Jatin **B**idesiya **D**omkach*" → "***J**ust **J**oin **B**ihar **D**aily*"

> 📖 **Story: Jhijhiya** = women balance **perforated pots with lamps** to **ward off black magic** (Dussehra, Mithila); **Jat-Jatin** = a **separated couple** (migration!); **Bidesiya** = **Bhikhari Thakur** ("**Shakespeare of Bhojpuri**") on **wives left behind by migrants**.

> 🎯 **Bihar's theme = MIGRATION** (Jat-Jatin + Bidesiya both!). *Bihar → labour migration → both dances are about longing.*

**JHARKHAND — "C-J-K-P"** → "***C**hhau **J**humair **K**arma **P**aiki*"

> 📖 **Story: Seraikella Chhau** = **symbolic masks**; **Jhumair** = signature harvest; **Karma** = around the **Karam tree** for **Karam Devta** (god of fate); **Paiki** = martial, **feeds into Chhau**.

> 🎯 **Karma = Karam tree = Jharkhand/Chhattisgarh/MP tribal belt.**

## 🔶 NORTHEAST

**ASSAM — "S-B-B-J-D"** → "***S**attriya **B**ihu **B**agurumba **J**humur **D**eodhani*"

> 📖 **Story: Sattriya** = from **Sattras**, by **Sankardeva**, **newest classical (2000)**; **Bihu** = spring harvest (**dhol + pepa**); **Bagurumba** = **Bodo "butterfly dance"** (women only); **Jhumur** = **tea-garden** tribes; **Deodhani** = **trance** at **Kamakhya**.

> 🎯 "***S**attriya = **S**ankardeva = **S**attra*" — triple S!

> 🎯 **Bagurumba = Bodo = Butterfly** — triple B!

**MANIPUR — "M-P-L-T"** → "***M**anipuri **P**ung Cholom **L**ai Haraoba **T**hang Ta*"

> 📖 **Story: Manipuri** = gentlest, **Potloi/Kumil barrel skirt**, Krishna **Raas** (**5 types!**); **Pung Cholom** = men **drum while leaping**; **Lai Haraoba** = "**merrymaking of the gods**" (pre-Vaishnavite, **maibis**); **Thang Ta** = **thang(sword) + ta(spear)**.

> 🎯 **Thang Ta = sword + spear. Sankirtana = UNESCO 2013.**

**MEGHALAYA — "N-W-S-B"** → "***N**ongkrem **W**angala **S**uk Mynsiem **B**ehdienkhlam*"

> 📖 **Story: KHASI** = **Nongkrem** (Smit, goat sacrifice) + **Shad Suk Mynsiem** ("joyful heart" — **girls inside, men outside**). **GARO** = **Wangala** = "**100 Drums**" for sun god **Misi Saljong**. **JAINTIA** = **Behdienkhlam** (men in **muddy pools**).

> 🎯 **TRIBE TRICK: Kha**si→**Nongkrem/Suk Mynsiem** · **Ga**ro→**Wa**ngala (**Ga**=**Wa**!) · **Jai**ntia→**Behdienkhlam/Laho**.

**MIZORAM — "C-K-C-S"** → "***C**heraw **K**huallam **C**hai **S**arlamkai*"

> 📖 **Story: Cheraw** = the **BAMBOO dance** — **Guinness 2010: 10,736 dancers**; **Khuallam** = "**dance of the guests**" (*puandum* cloth); **Sarlamkai** = after a **head-hunting raid**.

> 🎯 **Cheraw = Mizoram bamboo.** *Don't confuse with **Nagaland's Kuki bamboo dance**!*

**NAGALAND — "R-A-C-N"** → "***R**angma **A**aluyattu **C**hangai **N**suirolians*"

> 📖 **Story: Angami** → **Rangma war dance** (full battle gear, **Sekrenyi**); **Konyak** (tattooed faces!) → **Aaluyattu** (**Aoleang**); **Ao** → **Changai** (**Moatsu**); **Chakhesang** → **Cock dance**.

> 🎯 **TRIBE→FESTIVAL: A**ngami-**Sekrenyi** · **A**o-**Moatsu** · **K**onyak-**Aoleang** · **S**umi-**Tuluni**. All showcased at the **Hornbill Festival**.

**TRIPURA — "H-G-J-M"** → "***H**ojagiri **G**aria **J**hum **M**amita*"

> 📖 **Story: Hojagiri** = **Reang** women balance a **pitcher on the head + lamps on the hands**, moving **only the lower body** (Laxmi Puja!); **Garia** = around the **bamboo pole deity**.

> 🎯 **Hojagiri = Reang + balancing + only lower body moves.** "***Ho**jagiri* = ***Ho**w do they do it?!*"

**ARUNACHAL — "B-P-A-W"** → "***B**ardo Chham **P**onung **A**ji Lhamu **W**ancho*"

> 📖 **Story: Bardo Chham** = **Sherdukpen**, **wooden animal masks**, "bardo" = **limbo between death & rebirth**; **Ponung** = **Adi** tribe at **Solung**; **Monpa** = Buddhist masks (**Tawang**).

> 🎯 **TRIBE TRICK: Sherdukpen**-Bardo · **Adi**-Ponung/Popir · **Monpa**-Aji Lhamu/Chham · **Nyishi**-Rikham Pada · **Apatani**-Dree.

**SIKKIM — "S-C-M-C"** → "***S**inghi Chham **C**haam **M**aruni **C**hu Faat*"

> 📖 **Story: Singhi Chham** = the **SNOW LION** dance — because **Kanchenjunga's peaks look like a snow lion**! (**Pang Lhabsol**, by **Chador Namgyal**). **Maruni** = **Nepali**, Tihar/Diwali. **Chu Faat** = **Lepcha**, honours Kanchenjunga.

> 🎯 **Sikkim's theme = KANCHENJUNGA** (Singhi Chham + Chu Faat both honour it!).

### 🔷 CENTRAL

**MADHYA PRADESH — "T-G-M-J-B"** → "***T****ertali* ***G****aur Maria* ***M****atki* ***J****awara* ***B****hagoria*"

> 📖 **Story: Tertali** = **seated** women with **13 manjiras tied to the body** (+ sword in teeth!); **Gaur Maria** = **bison-horn headgear** (Gond); **Matki** = **veiled** woman + pot; **Jawara** = **wheat-sprout baskets**; **Bhagoria** = **Bhil "elopement"** festival before Holi!

> 🎯 **Tertali = TERA (13) + TAALI (cymbals)** — the name IS the answer!

> 🎯 **Bhagoria = Bhil + elopement + Holi.** "***Bhag****oria* = ***bhag*** *jao (run away)!*" — literally the eloping dance.

**CHHATTISGARH — "P-P-R-S"** → "***P****anthi* ***P****andavani* ***R****aut Nacha* ***S****uwa*"

> 📖 **Story: Panthi** = **Satnami**, **Guru Ghasidas'** birthday, **human pyramids**, white **Jaitkhamb** pillar; **Pandavani** = **Mahabharata via BHIMA** — **Teejan Bai** (Kapalik style) with a **peacock-feather tambura**; **Raut Nacha** = Krishna, **gods waking up** (Dev Uthni Ekadashi); **Suwa** = **parrot dance** (women, Diwali).

> 🎯 **Pandavani = Bhima + Teejan Bai. Panthi = Guru Ghasidas + pyramids.** *Both start with "****P****" —* ***Pandavani = People's epic****,* ***Panthi = Pyramid****.*

## 4.3 CROSS-STATE CONFUSION BUSTERS ⚠

These are the pairs SSC uses to trick you.

| Confusion | The Fix |
|---|---|
| **Ghoomar** — Rajasthan or Haryana? | **BOTH**, but famous as **Rajasthan** (Bhil origin → Rajput) |
| **Jhumar** — Punjab/Haryana/Jharkhand? | **Punjab & Haryana = Jhumar** (men, graceful) · **Jharkhand/WB/Bihar = Jhumair** (harvest). *Spelling differs!* |
| **Bhavai** — Rajasthan or Gujarat? | **Rajasthan = pot-balancing dance** · **Gujarat = folk THEATRE**. *Same name, different art!* |
| **Chhau** — which state? | **ALL THREE**: Odisha(Mayurbhanj, **no mask**), WB(Purulia, **character mask**), Jharkhand(Seraikella, **symbolic mask**) |
| **Karma** — MP/Chhattisgarh/Jharkhand? | **All 3** (tribal belt): Gond, Baiga, Oraon, Munda — around the **Karam tree** |
| **Kolattam / Kolkali / Kolata** | **Kolattam**=TN/AP · **Kolkali**=Kerala/**Lakshadweep** · **Kolata**=Karnataka. *All stick dances!* |
| **Theyyam vs Bhuta Kola** | **Theyyam = Kerala** · **Bhuta Kola = Karnataka (Tulunadu)**. Twin spirit-possession forms |
| **Tarpa** — Maharashtra or DNH? | **BOTH** — **Warli tribe** spans both. DNH's *signature*, Maharashtra's Palghar/Thane |
| **Cheraw vs Kuki bamboo dance** | **Cheraw = MIZORAM** (famous) · **Kuki dance = Nagaland**. Both bamboo! |
| **Lavani** — is it classical? | **NO!** It's **folk**. Only **8 SNA classical** dances exist |
| **Garba vs Dandiya** | **Garba = circle round the lamp-pot, before aarti** · **Dandiya = sticks, after aarti** |
| **Bihu vs Bagurumba** (Assam) | **Bihu = Assamese, spring harvest** · **Bagurumba = BODO tribe, butterfly, women only** |
| **Pot-balancing dances** | **Bhavai**(Raj) · **Chari**(Raj, +lamps) · **Matki**(MP, veiled) · **Karakattam**(TN, Mariamman) · **Hojagiri**(Tripura, +lamps on hands) · **Jhijhiya**(Bihar, perforated) |
| **Dances with NO instruments** | **Fugdi**(Goa) · **Kummi**(TN) · **Giddha**(Punjab) · **Suwa**(Chhattisgarh) — *all clapping only!* |

## 4.4 THEME CLUSTERS (learn 5 at a time)

| Theme | Dances |
|---|---|
| 🐅 **Animal mimicry** | **Mayilattam**(peacock-TN) · **Puliyattam**(tiger-TN) · **Bagha Nacha**(tiger-Odisha) · **Hulivesha**(tiger-Karnataka) · **Bagurumba**(butterfly-Assam) · **Butterfly Dance**(Nagaland) · **Singhi Chham**(snow lion-Sikkim) · **Yak Chham**(Sikkim) · **Nsuirolians**(cock-Nagaland) |
| 🐎 **Dummy horse** | **Kachchhi Ghodi**(Rajasthan) · **Ghode Modni**(Goa) · **Chaiti Ghoda**(Odisha) · **Poikkaal Kudhirai**(TN) |
| ⚔️ **Martial** | **Thoda**(HP-archery) · **Chholiya**(Uttarakhand-sword) · **Thang Ta**(Manipur) · **Kalaripayattu**(Kerala) · **Silambattam**(TN-staff) · **Perini**(Telangana) · **Raibenshe**(WB) · **Paika/Paiki**(Odisha/Jharkhand) · **Khukuri**(Sikkim) · **Rangma**(Nagaland) · **Spao**(Ladakh) |
| 🎭 **Masked** | **Chhau**(Purulia/Seraikella) · **Bardo Chham**(Arunachal) · **Cham**(Ladakh) · **Singhi Chham**(Sikkim) · **Bohada/Bhavada**(Maharashtra/DNH) · **Padayani**(Kerala) · **Kummattikali**(Kerala) · **Gambhira**(WB) · **Butta Bommalu**(AP) |
| 🌾 **Harvest** | **Bhangra**(Punjab-Vaisakhi) · **Bihu**(Assam) · **Wangala**(Meghalaya) · **Jhumair**(Jharkhand) · **Karma**(tribal belt) · **Nuakhai/Dalkhai**(Odisha) · **Loor/Phaag**(Haryana) · **Grida/Jawara**(MP) |
| 🪔 **Lamps/fire** | **Charkula**(UP-108 lamps) · **Chari**(Rajasthan) · **Hojagiri**(Tripura) · **Jhijhiya**(Bihar) · **Dhunuchi**(WB-incense) · **Thiruvathirakali**(Kerala-round a lamp) · **Chu Faat**(Sikkim-butter lamps) |
| 🥁 **Drum-named** | **Dollu Kunitha**(Karnataka) · **Pung Cholom**(Manipur) · **Dhol Cholom**(Manipur) · **Wangala/dama**(Meghalaya) · **Ghumra**(Odisha) · **Dappu/Tappeta Gullu**(AP/Telangana) · **Thappattam**(TN) · **Dhamal**(Haryana) |
| 👩 **Women-only** | **Giddha**(Punjab) · **Bagurumba**(Assam) · **Hojagiri**(Tripura) · **Fugdi/Dhalo**(Goa) · **Khoria/Loor**(Haryana) · **Suwa**(Chhattisgarh) · **Jhijhiya**(Bihar) · **Mohiniyattam**(Kerala) · **Kummi**(TN) |
| 👨 **Men-only** | **Dumhal**(J&K-Wattal) · **Perini**(Telangana) · **Pung Cholom**(Manipur) · **Kathakali**(Kerala, traditionally) · **Shad Sukra**(Meghalaya) · **Panthi**(Chhattisgarh) |

## 4.5 THE 60-SECOND FINAL REVISION

> Read this last, the night before.

- **8 classical** 📕 *(NCERT confirms 8 — **Chhau is NOT one**)*: Bharatanatyam-TN · Kathak-UP · **Kathakali & Mohiniyattam-Kerala** · Kuchipudi-AP · Odissi-Odisha · Manipuri-Manipur · Sattriya-Assam *(newest, 2000)*
- 📕 **NCERT dance taxonomy:** Tribal · Folk · Classical · Modern. **Modern pioneers:** Uday Shankar, Chitralekha, Narendra Sharma.

- 📕 **Natyaveda = 5th Veda:** Rig→**recitation** · Sama→**song** · Yajur→**acting** · Atharva→**rasa**.
- 📕 **Instruments: Tat**(string) · **Suṣīr**(wind) · **Avanaddha**(percussion) · **Ghana**("brass or wood").
- **UNESCO dances: Chhau**(2010) · **Kalbelia**(2010) · **Garba**(2023). *Koodiyattam(2008)=theatre, India's first.*
- **Guinness: Nati**(HP, 9,892) · **Cheraw**(Mizoram, 10,736)
- **Name = answer:** Ter**tali**=13 taalis · **Mayil**=peacock · **Puli**=tiger · **Thang Ta**=sword+spear · **Singhi**=lion · **Bagurumba**=Bodo Butterfly
- **Person-linked:** Sattriya-**Sankardeva** · Kuchipudi-**Siddhendra Yogi** · Bidesiya-**Bhikhari Thakur** · Pandavani-**Teejan Bai** · Panthi-**Guru Ghasidas** · Ottan Thullal-**Kunchan Nambiar** · Perini-**Nataraja Ramakrishna** · Bharatanatyam-**Rukmini Devi** · Odissi-**Kelucharan Mohapatra** · Kalbelia-**Gulabo Sapera**
- **Chhau masks: M**ayurbhanj=**No** mask · Purulia=character · Seraikella=symbolic
- **No instruments:** Fugdi · Kummi · Giddha · Suwa
- **Kerala = 2 classicals. Lavani ≠ classical.**